



CITY: Pg 3

Delhi govt issues more than 8 lakh Pink Saheli Smart Cards



NATION: Pg 5

AIADMK rift deepens as EPS, rebels dig in



FILM: Pg 14

'Have done certain films in South when I was young'

INNOVATION, SUSTAINABILITY IN SHARP FOCUS

India and Nordics go green together

MPOST BUREAU

OSLO: India and the Nordic countries on Tuesday decided to elevate their relationship to a Green Technology and Innovation Strategic Partnership, as Prime Minister Narendra Modi held talks with his Nordic counterparts, focusing on clean energy, sustainability, innovation, emerging technologies and other key areas.

In a joint press statement following the 3rd India-Nordic Summit in Oslo, PM Modi also said that India and the Nordic nations "have a clear and united stand on terrorism: No compromise, no double standards." PM Modi was joined by his counterparts from Norway, Sweden, Iceland, Denmark and Finland for high-level discussions.

PM Modi said India and the Nordic region can combine Nordic expertise in sustainability with India's scale to develop trusted global solutions for the future.

"Today, we decided to elevate India-Nordic relations to a Green Technology and Innovation Strategic Partner-



Swedish Prime Minister Ulf Kristersson and Prime Minister Narendra Modi at the press conference after the meeting between India and the Nordic countries at the City Hall in Oslo, on Tuesday

ship. With this green technology partnership, we will ensure a better future for the entire world," Modi said, noting that the format was established eight years ago to energise and accelerate India's relations with the Nordic countries.

The Prime Minister highlighted the steady growth in India-Nordic relations, noting that trade has increased four-fold over the past decade, while investments from Nordic countries in India have risen by around 200 per cent. He added that this

growth has not only supported India's development but has also generated employment opportunities in Nordic countries.

He said the upgraded partnership will focus on leveraging the strengths of each Nordic nation. He pointed out that Ice-

"Today, we decided to elevate India-Nordic relations to a Green Technology and Innovation Strategic Partnership. With this green technology partnership, we will ensure a better future for the entire world

— PM MODI

land brings expertise in geothermal energy and fisheries, Norway in the blue economy and Arctic affairs, Sweden in advanced manufacturing and defence, Finland in telecommunications and digital technologies, and Denmark in cybersecurity and health technologies. He also said cooperation is being strengthened at the level of universities, laboratories, and start-up ecosystems to promote research, skill development, and talent mobility between the two sides.

Continued on P4

Oslo spotlight

MPOST BUREAU

OSLO: Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to Norway, part of a five-nation tour, produced a flashpoint when a Norwegian journalist's attempt to ask him a question spiralled from the media rooms to online platforms and became viral.

A tense press briefing followed, with a troll battle on social media in parallel, plus a political war of words back home in India.

The episode began on Monday, Oslo time, at a joint press statement by PM Modi and his Norwegian counterpart Jonas Gahr Store. As the two leaders were leaving the venue — after their briefing done in a format that did not include a question-and-answer session — a voice

Continued on P4

Another 90-paise blow at pumps

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Petrol and diesel prices were raised by about 90 paise per litre on Tuesday, marking the second hike within a week - as state-run fuel retailers moved to narrow mounting losses triggered by a sharp surge in global crude oil prices following the Iran conflict.

In Delhi, petrol price rose to Rs 98.64 per litre, up from Rs 97.77, while diesel has increased to Rs 91.58 from Rs 90.67, according to agency reports. This follows an earlier hike of Rs 3 per litre on Friday.

Across metros, fuel prices saw similar increases. In Mumbai, petrol rose by 91 paise to Rs 107.59 per litre and diesel by 94 paise to Rs 94.08. Kolkata recorded the sharpest petrol hike of 96 paise, taking the price to Rs 109.70 per litre, while diesel climbed by 94 paise to Rs 96.07.

In Chennai, petrol prices went up by 82 paise to Rs 104.49 per litre, and diesel increased by 86 paise to Rs 96.11 per litre.

The back-to-back increases come after global crude oil prices surged more than 50 per cent since late February following US-Israeli strikes on Iran and disruptions to shipments through the Strait of Hormuz, a critical global oil transit route.

Fuel retailers had kept pump prices low despite rising input costs, a move the government said was aimed at shielding consumers from



METRO RATES

» In Delhi, petrol price rose to Rs 98.64 per litre, up from Rs 97.77, while diesel has increased to Rs 91.58 from Rs 90.67

» In Mumbai, petrol rose by 91 paise to Rs 107.59 per litre and diesel by 94 paise to Rs 94.08

» Kolkata recorded the sharpest petrol hike of 96 paise, taking the price to Rs 109.70 per litre, while diesel climbed by 94 paise to Rs 96.07

» In Chennai, petrol prices went up by 82 paise to Rs 104.49 per litre, and diesel increased by 86 paise to Rs 96.11 per litre

inflation. Opposition parties, however, accused the government of delaying price revisions until after key state elections.

Continued on P4

B'desh: Indian official found dead at Chattogram mission

DHAKA: An official of the Indian High Commission in Chattogram, Bangladesh, was found dead inside the mission premises on Tuesday, police said.

The deceased has been identified as Naren Dhar, who was serving as an Assistant Protocol Officer at the Indian mission.

"We have been told he was Naren Dhar and serving as the assistant protocol officer at the mission," the port city's police spokesman, Aminur Rashid, told reporters.

He said the official was in his late 30s. His body was found in front of a bathroom door early in the morning on the second floor of the old visa centre building of the diplomatic mission.

The Indian High Commission in Dhaka or the Assistant High Commission in Chattogram has so far made no comment on the death, which police initially suspected could have been caused by a cardiac arrest.

"The post-mortem report, however, will confirm the cause of the death," said Rashid, also the Assistant Police Commissioner of the city.

He said police reached the scene immediately after receiving the news in the morning and sent the body to state-run Chattogram Medical College Hospital morgue for autopsy after accomplishing required formalities since he was a foreign national serving at the diplomatic mission. Police said that, according to their information, Dhar hailed from Chandigarh.

POWER HITS SEASON HIGH Capital bakes at 45°C



OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi's peak power demand on Tuesday rose to this summer season's highest at 7,776 MW, as the mercury shot up to over 45 degrees Celsius.

According to the State Load Dispatch Centre (SLDC) Delhi, the peak power demand was 7,776 MW at 3.30 pm. On Monday, the power demand first peaked to 7,542 MW at 4.05 pm and then soared further to 7,600 MW at 11.11 pm.

The city experienced its hottest day this summer, with maximum temperature soaring to 45.1 degrees Celsius. The maximum temperature on Monday was recorded at 43.4 degrees Celsius, the second-highest this summer.

The weather department has forecast severe heatwave conditions in isolated parts of the national capital next week.

Delhi's peak power demand has seen a sharp rise in May compared to previous years, reflecting the impact of an intense and early summer, discom officials said.

Earlier this year, Delhi's peak

Poor air brings back GRAP-1

NEW DELHI: The Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) Delhi, the peak power demand was 7,776 MW at 3.30 pm. On Monday, the power demand first peaked to 7,542 MW at 4.05 pm and then soared further to 7,600 MW at 11.11 pm.

The city experienced its hottest day this summer, with maximum temperature soaring to 45.1 degrees Celsius. The maximum temperature on Monday was recorded at 43.4 degrees Celsius, the second-highest this summer.

The weather department has forecast severe heatwave conditions in isolated parts of the national capital next week.

Earlier this year, Delhi's peak

GARLANDED, CARRIED ON SHOULDERS IN GHAZIABAD

Rape accused gets hero's welcome

DIPIKA KIROLA

GHAZIABAD: A video showing a grand welcome being accorded to a former member of the Hindu Yuva Vahini, accused of raping an LLB student, after his release on bail from a jail in Delhi NCR region's Ghaziabad has triggered sharp political reactions and criticism on social media.

The video, which has gone viral online, shows rape accused Sushil Prajapati being greeted with garlands and cheers by a large group of supporters outside the jail premises. Supporters were seen lifting him on their shoulders, raising slogans and recording videos on mobile phones as he walked in a celebratory procession.

POLITICAL STORM

» Reacting strongly to the celebrations following Prajapati's release on bail, Samajwadi Party Chief Akhilesh Yadav launched a sharp attack on the Uttar Pradesh government and the ruling BJP

» The video, which has gone viral online, shows rape accused Sushil Prajapati being greeted with garlands and cheers by a large group of supporters outside the jail premises

» SUPPORTERS WERE SEEN LIFTING HIM ON THEIR SHOULDERS, RAISING SLOGANS AND RECORDING VIDEOS ON MOBILE PHONES AS HE WALKED IN A CELEBRATORY PROCESSION

Some supporters were also seen flashing victory signs during the gathering.

According to local police officials, the incident would be examined after the video sur-

ARRIVES IN BEIJING FOR 2-DAY VISIT Putin set for Sept 12-13 BRICS Summit in Delhi

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

MOSCOW: Russian President Vladimir Putin will attend the BRICS Summit in New Delhi on September 12-13, according to a presidential aide.

India, as the chair of the BRICS, will host the annual Summit of the grouping in September.

President Putin will take part in the BRICS Summit in New Delhi on September 12 and 13, Kremlin aide for international affairs Yuri Ushakov was quoted as saying by the state-run TASS news agency. He also added that a bilateral



eral meeting between President Putin and Chinese President Xi Jinping is planned on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit in New Delhi.

TMC's Falta candidate Jahangir withdraws from re-poll

'Stepping aside to ensure peace and prosperity...'

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLKATA: In a dramatic twist hours before campaigning for the Falta Assembly re-poll ended on Tuesday, Trinamool Congress candidate Jahangir Khan announced his withdrawal from the contest, saying he wanted to pave the way for development initiatives promised by Chief Minister Suvenudh Adhikari for the constituency.

"I dreamt that Falta should become 'Golden Falta'. The Chief Minister has said a special package will be announced for Falta. I am the son of the soil. I am stepping aside to ensure peace and prosperity for



Jahangir Khan

Falta and its people," Khan said.

However, the Trinamool Congress distanced itself from the decision, asserting that the withdrawal was Khan's "personal decision" and alleging that he had "succumbed to pressure" from the BJP.

Rupee crashes to record low

MUMBAI: The rupee descended for the eighth consecutive session and ended 50 paise down at its lowest-ever level of 96.70 against the US dollar on Tuesday, weighed down by soaring crude oil prices, persistent foreign capital outflows, and a resilient dollar buoyed by global risk-aversion.

Continued on P4

How will fuel price play out

NEW DELHI: India's inflation debate appears to be entering a complicated phase. On the surface, retail inflation appears under control, giving consumers and policymakers some relief. But beneath that, wholesale prices rose sharply in April, even before petrol and diesel prices were increased.

See P10

KEY POINTS

- » Jahangir Khan announced his withdrawal from the contest, saying he wanted to pave the way for development initiatives
- » Trinamool Congress distanced itself from the decision, asserting that the withdrawal was Khan's "personal decision"
- » The contest in Falta will now be among BJP candidate Debangshu Panda, Congress nominee Abdur Razzak Molla and CPI(M) candidate Sambhu Nath Kurmi

With Khan stepping aside, the contest in Falta will now be among BJP candidate Debangshu Panda, Congress nominee Abdur Razzak Molla and CPI(M) candidate Sambhu Nath Kurmi.

Chief Minister Adhikari,

who held a roadshow in Falta on Tuesday, claimed Khan "ran away as he would not get any polling agent". Campaigning for BJP candidate Panda, Adhikari said Khan had "no choice" but to withdraw.

Continued on P4

NEET leak probe widens to Nagpur

Devices, notes seized during searches

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI/NAGPUR: The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI), probing the NEET-UG 2026 paper leak case, has conducted searches at the houses of two students in Nagpur, officials said on Tuesday.

The searches were conducted on Monday at their residences located in the Central Avenue and Itwari areas, during which the probe agency seized mobile phones, laptops, handwritten notes and other digital devices for forensic examination.

These students had appeared for the NEET exam-



ination this year and were repeaters preparing through private coaching institutes, the officials said.

The CBI suspects that they allegedly received leaked question papers through a network operating from Pune with sources claiming that the paper was arranged for nearly Rs 15 lakh per candidate.

Continued on P4

INTERNAL BLEEDING, BRAIN TRAUMA...

Postmortem reveals severe injuries in Deepika Nagar dowry death case

DIPIKA KIROLA

GREATER NOIDA: The post-mortem report of 24-year-old Deepika Nagar has revealed multiple grievous injuries and severe internal trauma, deepening suspicion in the alleged dowry harassment case.

Deepika allegedly died after falling from the roof of her house in Jalpura village on Sunday amid claims of sustained mental and physical harassment linked to dowry demands. Following a complaint by her family, police arrested her husband, Ritik Nagar, and father-in-law, Manoj Nagar, while five other accused family members are absconding.

According to the postmortem findings, Deepika suffered extensive external and internal injuries. Doctors noted a large swelling on the right side of her



face, injuries on the left elbow and forearm, and a massive contusion on the right thigh. A bone-deep wound was also found on her left knee, while injury marks were detected near the waist and abdomen.

The report further mentioned circular contusions above the right iliac crest and

around the right arm, along with bleeding from the left ear and deep abrasion marks on the chest and abdomen.

During the internal examination, doctors found a hematoma on the middle and left side of the brain, indicating severe head trauma. The spleen was ruptured and heavy inter-

TAKEAWAYS

- » Deepika suffered extensive external and internal injuries
- » Doctors noted a large swelling on the right side of her face, injuries on the left elbow, forearm, and a massive contusion on the right thigh
- » Cops are trying to determine whether injuries inflicted before the fall

nal bleeding was observed in different parts of the body. The left kidney appeared pale, while the chambers of the heart were found empty, suggesting excessive blood loss.

Police sources said investigators are trying to determine whether the injuries were inflicted before the fall

or resulted from impact with the iron grill and net below the building.

"A detailed investigation is underway and the arrested accused will be questioned further. Four teams have been formed to nab the remaining absconding accused," a senior police officer told

The victim's family alleged that Deepika was repeatedly harassed and assaulted for dowry after her marriage around one-and-a-half years ago. According to relatives, the family spent nearly Rs 1 crore on the wedding, but the accused allegedly continued demanding additional cash and a Toyota Fortuner SUV.

Family members claimed Deepika was frequently tortured and pressured over the demands, ultimately pushing her into extreme distress.

Man immolates self outside wife's residence, dies: Cops

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A 29-year-old man died after allegedly setting himself on fire outside his wife's residence in northwest Delhi after she left him over domestic violence and allegations that he duped her by posing as an Indian Forest Service officer, police said on Tuesday.

The deceased was identified as Deepansh Chaudhary (29), a native of Gujarat.

Police said initial claims that he had been set ablaze by his wife and mother-in-law were found to be incorrect during an investigation. According to police, a PCR call regarding a fire incident was received on Monday night, following which personnel rushed to Jahangirpuri and found Deepansh with severe burn injuries.

He was sent to Babu Jagjivan Ram Memorial (BJRM) Hospital, where he succumbed during treatment, police said, adding that he sustained 90 per cent burn injuries.

During the incident, Deepansh had accused his wife and



mother-in-law of setting him on fire, police said.

However, sustained questioning of family members, local witnesses and examination of the sequence of events revealed that he had allegedly immolated himself outside the house in an apparent attempt to implicate them, police added.

Police said Deepansh and his wife had been facing matrimonial discord for some time, and counselling proceedings were already underway at the Crime Against Women (CAW) Cell. Speaking to reporters, Deepansh's wife alleged that he had been threatening and assaulting her shortly after their marriage.

"My husband threatened

to kill me on May 11. The next day, I went to a restaurant and asked for help, and they took me to the police station. Since then, he had been absconding," she said.

She alleged that on Monday, Deepansh called her asking her to collect clothes and documents that were with him. "When I went there, he snatched my mobile phone and ran away. I again went to the police station to complain. When police called him, he told them, 'In the evening take both her phone and dead body,'" she claimed.

According to her, the police then advised her to block his number and avoid speaking to him. "Around 8.30 pm, he came to my house, rang the bell and shouted at me, saying he would not leave me alive. When I did not come out, he shouted that he would teach me a lesson," she alleged.

Police said Deepansh allegedly consumed phenyl and set himself on fire after his wife refused to return with him.

News at a Glance

CAPITAL LOGS 18 DENGUE CASES TILL MAY 16; MALARIA TALLY AT 33: MCD

NEW DELHI: Delhi recorded 18 dengue cases till May 16, according to the latest weekly vector-borne disease report issued by the Municipal Corporation of Delhi. Dengue cases remained stable till mid-May compared to April, when 52 infections were reported. The report also showed 33 malaria cases this year, lower than 47 during the corresponding period last year. Of the total malaria cases, 32 were reported from MCD zones and one from the NDMC area. No dengue or malaria-related deaths have been recorded so far this year. Delhi had reported 744 malaria cases in 2025, 792 in 2024 and 426 in 2023.

POLICE CRACK APK-BASED CYBER SCAM

NEW DELHI: The Cyber Cell of Delhi Police has busted a cyber fraud racket that used malicious mobile applications to remotely access victims' phones and siphon money from bank accounts. Two accused from Uttar Pradesh — Abhay Sahani (25), the alleged mastermind, and Umesh Kumar Rajak (25) — have been arrested. Police said the gang used fake electricity bill calls to trick victims into installing a malicious APK sent via WhatsApp. In one case, a complainant was cheated of Rs 1,20,999. Investigators recovered mobile phones, debit cards, SIM cards, a crypto wallet and a car allegedly bought using proceeds of crime.

Four gang members involved in robbery and murder nabbed

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police have arrested three members of a gang, including alleged parole jumper Prince alias Mohit alias Baba (25), along with one juvenile, in connection with cases of murder, robbery and firing incidents in Jahangir Puri. The other accused were identified as Radhe (22) and Shantanu alias Chika (18).

Police said the gang used to flaunt illegal firearms on social media to create fear among residents. The action followed a complaint alleging threats and firing outside a resident's house over an old enmity linked to a 2020 murder case. Two illegal pistols recovered. MPOST

Delhi Univ girls hostel residents allege forced eviction, poor facilities, high vacation charges

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Students of University of Delhi's Rajiv Gandhi Girls Hostel have been protesting against what they describe as forced eviction during the summer vacation, steep temporary accommodation charges and poor hostel facilities.

According to students, outstation residents have been directed to vacate their hostel rooms within seven days of the completion of examinations. Several students alleged that the move has left many without accommodation despite having to remain in Delhi for competitive examinations, internships

and academic work.

Students claimed that the hostel administration is charging ₹300 per day during the vacation period along with an additional ₹1,000 monthly cooler fee, substantially increasing the regular hostel expenses. Protesters have demanded that students be allowed to continue staying at the existing institutional fee structure until the university releases the second hostel allotment list.

The protests intensified after students gathered outside the hostel premises raising concerns over inadequate facilities, including limited cooling arrangements and poor food



'Hostel is charging Rs 300/day during the vacation period'

quality. Some residents also alleged that hostel gates were

locked to prevent students from joining the demonstration outside the campus.

The Students' Federation of India criticised the administration over what it termed the growing commercialisation of university hostels, arguing that rising accommodation costs were placing an unfair burden on students from financially weaker backgrounds. The organisation also pointed to earlier demonstrations at Miranda House Hostel and the University Hostel for Women over comparable accommodation and fee-related grievances. In response, hostel authorities said instructions had been

issued by the Vice-Chancellor and the Proctor's Office to maintain security and administrative oversight within the hostel premises during the vacation period. Officials added that deliberations concerning accommodation charges were still underway and urged students to await a formal communication from the administration.

Students have also expressed concern that overstaying beyond the permitted period could affect them during examination time, especially those involved in research and other academic requirements.

Boy falls to death from 15th floor

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NOIDA: A four-year-old boy died after falling from the 15th floor of an under-construction building in Greater Noida, police said on Tuesday.

The incident took place on Monday at Tower D of Lohia Enclave Society in the Omicron-1A area under the Kasma police station limits.

Police identified the deceased as Ansh, son of Arun, a resident of Ballia district in Uttar Pradesh.

According to police, the boy's parents, who work as labourers, were engaged in construction work in the building at the time of the incident, while the child was



playing nearby.

"He died while playing on the 15th floor and fell from the balcony of an under-construction high-rise building," police at Kasma police station said.

The body has been sent for postmortem examination and further investigation is underway, police added. MPOST

Police apprehend 7 juveniles for brutal attack on 16-yr-old

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police have apprehended seven juveniles for allegedly stabbing a 16-year-old boy in an attempt to murder case in Shakurpur's Children's Park.

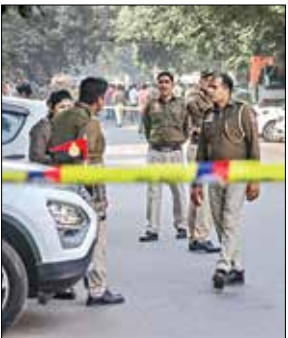
Police received a PCR call regarding the incident on May 15 at around 8.17 pm under the jurisdiction of Subhash Place Police Station. On reaching the spot near H-Block Masjid Wali Gali, officers found the victim, identified as Sahid, critically injured with a knife lodged in the left flank region of his body.

The teenager was immediately shifted to Bhagwan Mahavir Hospital and later referred to Safdarjung Hospital due to the seriousness of his injuries.

Station House Officer Inspector Tej Pal Singh supervised the rescue operation and ensured the victim was shifted during the crucial 'golden hour'.

A separate police vehicle also transported a medical team to ensure uninterrupted emergency care during transit. Police registered an FIR under Sections 109(1) and 3(5) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and formed a dedicated investigation team under Inspector Tej Pal Singh, supervised by ACP Srishri Bhatt.

Using technical surveillance, local intelligence inputs and multiple raids, investigators apprehended seven children in conflict with law allegedly involved in the attack. Police said the knife used in



KEY POINTS

- » Station House Officer Inspector Tej Pal Singh supervised the rescue operation and ensured the victim was shifted during the crucial 'golden hour'
- » A separate police vehicle also transported a medical team to ensure uninterrupted emergency care during transit
- » Further investigation is underway to ascertain the motive behind the attack and identify the person who procured the weapon: Police

the crime had been purchased online through Flipkart nearly three days before the incident. Further investigation is underway to ascertain the motive behind the attack and identify the person who procured the weapon.

BEAT THE HEAT

Delhi govt to distribute kits having sattu, ORS, gamcha to 1L construction workers

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government will distribute special kits containing sattu, ORS, sherbat syrup, prickly heat powder, gamcha and other items, among one lakh construction workers in the city to help them cope with the intense summer heat, officials said on Tuesday.

The government has started the process to engage a public sector unit for procurement of the items, packaging and distribution of the summer kits to nearly one lakh workers registered with Delhi Building and Other Construction Workers Welfare Board, they said.

Each kit will have nine items including 250 grams of instant energy glucose, one kg premium quality sattu (roasted gram flour), 30 oral rehydration solution (ORS) sachets, cotton gamcha (towel), sun-light protection cap, prickly heat powder, one-litre water bottle, 250 ml of sherbat concentrate kept in a durable utility backpack.

The approximate cost of distribution of each kit is estimated to be Rs 1,890. The Board has started the process



for selection of a PSU for supply of summer kits to Delhi to the construction workers, officials said. The Delhi government recognises that construction workers engaged in outdoor and labour-intensive activities are particularly vulnerable to extreme summer conditions and heatwave related occupational risks such as dehydration, heat stress, fatigue, and associated health complications. said a request for proposal (RFP) document issued by the Board.

The Board aims to ensure timely supply and distribution of the summer kits to approximately 1,00,000 registered construction workers to support their health, safety, and overall

working conditions.

The number of the construction workers may increase or decrease as per the conditions. Priority will be given to workers working on construction site, said the document

Since real-time authenticated data regarding construction workers presently engaged at construction sites in Delhi is not available with the Board, the estimated beneficiary coverage has been derived on the basis of active and renewed registered construction workers maintained in the database of the Board, it said.

Considering workforce mobility, seasonal migration, operational feasibility, budgetary availability, and

HIGHLIGHTS

» 'Each kit will have nine items including 250 grams of instant energy glucose, one kg premium quality sattu...'

» The approximate cost of distribution of each kit is estimated to be Rs 1,890

Delhi govt turns community halls & schools into summer shelters

NEW DELHI: With many patients' attendants forced to sleep outside hospitals in extreme heat, the Delhi government has converted schools and community halls near four major hospitals into temporary summer shelters with free basic facilities.

DUSIB has opened shelters near All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Lady Hardinge Medical College and Hospital, Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital and Safdarjung Hospital. Operational from May 15 to July 15, the shelters provide beds, coolers, fans, meals, ORS packets, drinking water and mobile toilets. Officials said the move aims to help attendants, especially those from outside Delhi, during the ongoing heatwave.

MPOST

Delhi govt issues more than 8 lakh Pink Saheli Smart Cards

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Delhi's public transport network has recorded a major expansion in women-focused mobility services, with more than eight lakh women being issued the 'Pink Saheli Smart Card' under a scheme launched by the Delhi Government and Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC). The initiative aims to provide free and digitally enabled bus travel facilities to women and transgender residents across the national capital.

According to the Delhi government, special registration camps are being organised across residential colonies and government offices to accelerate enrolment under the scheme and simplify the application process for commuters.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the increasing number of cardholders reflected growing participation of women in the city's public transport system. "The 'Pink Saheli Smart Card' is not merely a facility for free travel, but has emerged as a means of providing women with a dignified, secure and digitally empowered travel experience," she said.

The scheme is available to all women and transgender residents of Delhi above the age of



five years. The smart card operates on NCMC-based 'Tap-and-Go' technology, allowing passengers to travel on DTC buses without requiring paper tickets. Travel details are automatically recorded when the card is tapped on electronic ticketing machines installed in buses. Officials said the card has been designed to support future integration with Metro and other public transport systems. The facility also allows online recharge and access to digital travel records.

The Delhi Government stated that the registration process has been kept fully online to minimise inconvenience for applicants. "Special camps are being organised continuously to help women get the cards made easily," the Chief Minister said.

According to govern-

ment estimates, the scheme is helping regular commuters reduce monthly travel expenditure substantially, while also encouraging greater use of public transport among women passengers.

Highlighting the broader objective of the initiative, the Chief Minister said the government is working towards modernising Delhi's transport infrastructure through technology-driven and commuter-friendly systems. "The government's goal is to transform Delhi's public transport system into one that is completely women-friendly, smart and world-class," she said.

Officials said the outreach campaign and registration drives for the 'Pink Saheli Smart Card' scheme will continue across different parts of Delhi in the coming months.

Ramesh Bidhuri backs removal of bogus voters

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Senior BJP leader and former MP Ramesh Bidhuri on Monday said the party supports the removal of bogus, duplicate and deceased voters from electoral rolls to ensure free and fair elections in Delhi.

Bidhuri, along with advocate Sanket Gupta, attended a meeting of political parties convened by the Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) of Delhi regarding the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

According to a statement issued after the meeting, Bidhuri assured the election authorities that BJP-appointed Booth Level Agents (BLA-2) would extend full cooperation during the revision exercise.

"BJP believes all bogus voters, dead voters and infiltrators' names should be deleted from voter lists to ensure free and fair elections," Bidhuri said.

The Special Intensive Revision process is undertaken periodically by the Election Commission to verify and update voter lists by identifying duplicate entries, deceased voters and other ineligible names while ensuring that eligible citizens remain enrolled.

Satish Upadhyay appointed as Delhi Jal Board Vice Chairman

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Malviya Nagar MLA Satish Upadhyay has been nominated as the Vice Chairman of the Delhi Jal Board (DJB), while BJP legislators Manoj Kumar Shokeen and Ajay Kumar Mahawar have been appointed as members of the board, according to an order issued by the Delhi Legislative Assembly Secretariat.

The appointments were announced by Delhi Assembly Speaker Vijender Gupta on Monday. The post of Vice Chairman had remained vacant for nearly a year after the BJP formed the government in Delhi earlier this year. "MLA Satish Upadhyay from Malviya Nagar has been nominated as Vice Chairman of the Delhi Water Board, while MLA Manoj Kumar Shokeen from Nangloi Jat and MLA Ajay Kumar Mahawar from Ghonda have been nominated as Members of the Board respectively," the Speaker said.

Upadhyay is regarded as a senior BJP leader in Delhi politics with over four decades of organisational and public life experience. Born in New Delhi in 1962, he studied Political Science at ARSD College



Between 2021 and 2024, Upadhyay served as Vice Chairman of NDMC

under the University of Delhi and began his political journey through student politics. He first came into prominence after being elected Vice President of the Delhi University Students' Union (DUSU) during 1982-83.

Over the years, Upadhyay held several key positions within the BJP and its youth wing, including National Secretary of the Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP),

President of the Delhi BJP Youth Wing, Vice President of Delhi BJP and later President of the Delhi BJP between 2014 and 2016. He also served as Councillor from Malviya Nagar and chaired important committees in the erstwhile South Delhi Municipal Corporation.

Between 2021 and 2024, Upadhyay served as Vice Chairman of the New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC), where he was associated with projects related to hospital upgrades, sanitation systems, employee regularisation and urban beautification initiatives. He also played a role in preparations linked to the G20 Summit in Delhi.

Responding to his nomination, Upadhyay said, "This opportunity to serve the residents of Delhi is a matter of immense pride and responsibility for me. I will make every possible effort to live up to the expectations of the people with complete dedication, honesty and commitment."

The Delhi Jal Board is responsible for water supply and sewage management in the capital, while the Vice Chairman oversees its day-to-day functioning along with senior officials and board members.

Delhi-NCR to get e-ways, tunnels, elevated corridors under ₹1.60 lakh crore infra push

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday welcomed a series of major road and connectivity projects announced for Delhi-NCR and thanked Union Road Transport and Highways Minister Nitin Gadkari for what she described as a transformative infrastructure push for the national capital.

Addressing the media after a briefing by the Union Minister, Gupta said projects involving expressways, tunnels, elevated corridors and signal-free road networks would significantly improve connectivity

while helping Delhi tackle traffic congestion and pollution.

The Chief Minister said infrastructure projects worth Rs.1.31 lakh crore had already been sanctioned for Delhi-NCR over the past 12 years, while the overall value of completed, ongoing and upcoming projects had now reached nearly Rs.1.60 lakh crore.

Highlighting the Delhi-Mumbai Expressway link project, Gupta termed it a major development for the region and said it would improve connectivity between Delhi, Noida, Faridabad, Gurugram and

Jewar Airport.

Several upcoming projects were also announced during the briefing, including a Rs.3,500 crore six-lane corridor connecting UER-II with the Delhi-Dehradun Expressway, a Rs.7,500 crore Noida-Faridabad high-speed corridor, a tunnel project from Shiv Murti to Nelson Mandela Marg worth Rs.7,000 crore, and a Rs.5,000 crore elevated corridor from AIIMS to Mahipalpur-Gurugram.

"These projects will significantly reduce traffic pressure in the capital while strength-

ening regional connectivity," the Chief Minister said.

Gupta also stated that waste and inert material extracted from Delhi's landfill sites were being utilised in road construction projects. She said the combined efforts of the Centre and Delhi Government were contributing towards better waste management and improved urban infrastructure.

The Chief Minister expressed confidence that the projects would help Delhi evolve into a cleaner, smoother and more modern capital in the coming years.

MPOST

NDMC to clean Nehru Park Lake using bio-remediation treatment

NEW DELHI: The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) is set to clean-up the Nehru Park lake in Chanakyapuri through bio-remediation treatment and upkeep of water plants as part of infrastructure maintenance works. The civic body has invited online bids on May 15 and said the specialised maintenance work is aimed at ensuring sustained upkeep of the Nehru Park water body through bio-remediation treatment over eight months.

An algal bloom causes deterioration of the lake's water quality

According to officials, an algal bloom causes deterioration of the lake's water quality.

According to the tender document, the selected agency will undertake regular lake cleaning, removal of floating debris, maintenance of aquatic

plants, and treatment of water sludge and visible contamination. The work will involve the use of liquid biological agents and algae filtration equipment to purify the water and remove sludge. To control algal blooms in the lake's fountains, a natural algacide will be applied every month. NDMC invites bids for bio-remediation project to improve water quality through aeration and oxygen-enhancing treatment at water bodies.

PTI

Blaze in New Ashok Ngr PS

NEW DELHI: A fire broke out in the 'malkhana' of the New Ashok Nagar police station in east Delhi on Tuesday, prompting authorities to rush eight fire tenders to the spot, an official of the DFS said.

A call regarding fire breaking out in the 'malkhana' (store-room) of the police station was received at 1.06 pm, the Delhi Fire Services officer said.

"We rushed eight fire tenders to the spot and the fire-fighting operation is ongoing," the DFS officer said.

MPOST

NDMC chief travels by Metro

NEW DELHI: In a push for sustainable transport and fuel conservation, Keshav Chandra, Chairman of the New Delhi Municipal Council, travelled to office by Delhi Metro Rail Corporation on Tuesday, citing Prime Minister Narendra Modi's appeal for austerity and reduced fuel use.



He travelled from Lok Kalyan Marg Metro Station to Rajiv Chowk and later used an electric auto to reach Palika Kendra. NDMC also announced a 50 per cent parking concession for electric vehicles at its parking sites and expanded electric mobility services, including e-autos, shuttle buses and EV scooters for staff and commuters.

MPOST

Monsoon threat looms over MCD's Okhla Landfill clearance drive

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Sanjeev Khirwar on Tuesday reviewed bio mining and waste-processing operations at the Okhla Landfill Site as the Municipal Corporation of Delhi races against time to reduce legacy waste ahead of the monsoon season.

During the inspection, the Commissioner engaged in biomining activities and directed officials to speed up remediation work at the site. He also inspected the Construction and Demolition waste facility, the

engineered sanitary landfill and the compost plant at Okhla.

Deputy Commissioner Shashwat Saurabh and Engineer-in-Chief P.C. Meena were present during the visit. Officials indicated that repeated revisions in landfill clearance targets have occurred due to limited processing capacity and delays in remediation operations.

The timeline for flattening the Okhla dumpsite, initially fixed for December 2023, was later revised multiple times and now stands at July 2026.

Civic officials said the arrival of the monsoon by late June

could further slow biomining operations as wet waste becomes harder to process. Space constraints at the site have also limited the possibility of deploying additional machinery to accelerate waste removal.

At present, nearly 18 lakh metric tonnes of waste remain at Okhla, where 18 trommel machines are operational and around 25 acres of land have been cleared so far.

Across Delhi's three major legacy dumpsites, around 105 lakh metric tonnes of waste are still awaiting remediation, including approximately 67 lakh

metric tonnes at Ghazipur and 26 lakh metric tonnes at Bhalswa.

According to officials, around 4,000 to 5,000 metric tonnes of fresh waste continues to reach the landfill sites daily, alongside drain silt and ash generated by waste-to-energy plants, complicating the reclamation process.

The MCD has approached the Centre to include Delhi's three landfill sites under the Dumpsite Remediation Accelerator Programme launched under Swachh Bharat Mission-Urban 2.0 for scientific disposal of legacy waste.

EIGHT IIT-DELHI-TESTED ROAD SWEEPERS ADDED TO SANITATION FLEET

Mayor flags off mechanised road sweeping machines

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Mayor Pravesh Wahi on Tuesday flagged off eight truck-mounted Mechanical Road Sweeping (MRS) machines from the headquarters of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi at the Dr. S.P.M. Civic Centre, as part of efforts to strengthen mechanised sanitation and curb dust pollution in the Capital.

Deputy Mayor Monika Pant, Standing Committee Chairperson Satya Sharma,



Leader of the House Jai Bhagwan Yadav, IVP leader Mukesh Goyal and MCD Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar were among those present during the flagging-off ceremony.

Wahi said the civic body was expanding and modernising Delhi's sanitation infrastructure under the National Clean Air Programme (NCAP). He added that the newly inducted

Mechanised system would minimise the dependence on manual sweeping on high-speed roads

machines would primarily be deployed on roads with a right of way of 60 feet or more to improve the frequency and coverage of mechanised sweeping operations.

According to the Mayor, the move is aimed at reducing road dust pollution and improving air quality in the city. He also said the mechanised system would minimise the dependence on manual sweeping on high-speed roads and central verges, thereby improving the safety of sanitation workers exposed to traffic risks.

The Corporation stated that the machines would operate under a comprehensive operation and maintenance model to ensure regular upkeep and efficient utilisation. Wahi said the

vehicles had undergone quality inspection by Indian Institute of Technology Delhi before procurement.

Each machine has been procured at a cost of ₹58.69 lakh and has an estimated operational life of 10 years, officials said.

The Mayor reiterated the MCD's commitment to developing a technology-driven sanitation system focused on cleaner roads, improved worker safety and better environmental conditions in the city.

The proposed campaign seeks to provide a structured and dignified system for handling old or damaged idols that are often abandoned in public places such as roadsides, parks, near water bodies or under peepal trees after years of worship in homes.

Announcing the initiative, the Chief Minister said, "The idea is to ensure that religious faith is respected while environmental protection is also prioritised." She added that the campaign should evolve into "a people's movement" rather than remain limited to a government programme.

According to the Delhi Government, dedicated collection centres will be set up where citizens can deposit



damaged idols respectfully. These idols will subsequently be recycled using scientific and environmentally sustainable methods and converted into usable products.

Officials said the government is currently preparing a detailed action plan for the initiative and has sought direct public feedback before finalising the framework. As part of the consultation process, residents have been asked to suggest suitable locations for collection centres, including residential colonies, markets and local wards, and recommend measures to make the system more effective and dignified.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the idol recycling initiative aims to protect religious sentiments, improve cleanliness and promote environmentally sustainable waste management through public participation.

MPOST

'HEATWAVE CONDITIONS ARE EXPECTED TO CONTINUE FOR NEXT ONE WEEK'

India bakes under blistering heat; Banda in UP burns at 48 deg C

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Large parts of the country were in the grip of punishing heat, as Banda in Uttar Pradesh scorched at 48.2 degrees Celsius and authorities in Indore said on Tuesday that a four-year-old girl has died of suspected suffocation after getting trapped inside a car in scorching heat.

Soaring temperatures in Punjab made life difficult for people in Faridkot which sizzled at a day-temperature of 47.3 degrees, while most cities in the Vidarbha region of Maharashtra also reeled under intense heat wave conditions, with Amravati recording a high of 46.8 degrees.

It was a heatwave day in Delhi as temperatures in the city breached the 45 degrees-mark during the day.

In Madhya Pradesh's Indore, a four-year-old girl got trapped inside a car for



A man covers himself and his child due to intense heatwave on Tuesday PTI

several hours and was later found unconscious. Doctors declared her dead at the hospital. Authorities said she is suspected to have died of suffocation but the exact cause of death would be ascertained after a post-mortem.

In Uttar Pradesh, Banda

emerged as the hottest place in the state at 48.2 degrees Celsius, while temperatures crossed the 40 degrees Celsius mark in 22 of the state's 75 districts, according to the India Meteorological Department (IMD).

Among the hottest places in the state were Jhansi and

Highlights

» Among the hottest places in the state were Jhansi and Agra, which recorded a maximum temperature of 46.5 degrees Celsius each, followed by Prayagraj at 45.8 degrees Celsius

» The heat wave sweeping Punjab and Haryana further intensified, with Faridkot recording a high of 47.3 degrees

Agra, which recorded a maximum temperature of 46.5 degrees Celsius each, followed by Prayagraj at 45.8 degrees Celsius. In Lucknow, the maximum temperature settled at 40.9 degrees Celsius.

The weather office said heatwave to severe heatwave conditions were very likely

at many places in southern UP and at a few places in the remaining parts of the state. It also warned of warm night conditions at isolated places in western UP.

The health department is on alert following the IMD warning of severe heat and heatwave conditions over the next few days.

The ongoing heat wave sweeping Punjab and Haryana further intensified, with Faridkot recording a high of 47.3 degrees and Rohtak registering 46.9 degrees Celsius, the meteorological office said.

At several other places in the two northern states, maximum temperatures hovered close to the 45-degree Celsius mark.

In Himachal Pradesh, a yellow warning of a heatwave has been issued in Kangra and Solan for Wednesday by the meteorological office in Shimla on Tuesday.

U'khand: 3 coaches of Ujjaini Express derail near Rishikesh; no casualties



Damaged remains of a coach

PTI

RISHIKESH: Three coaches of the Ujjaini Express derailed near the Yog Nagari railway station here when the train was on its way to the railway yard, officials said on Tuesday.

There were no passengers on board when the incident occurred around 9:40 pm on Monday near Khand Gaon area, they said.

The train that operates between Lakshmibai Nagar in Indore and Yog Nagari in Rishikesh arrived at the Yog Nagari railway station at 6 pm on Monday and was scheduled to depart for its return journey

at 6.15 am on Tuesday.

Official sources said the incident occurred when the train was being moved from the platform to the railway yard. The locomotive collided with the buffer (dead end) located at the terminus of the shunting line, resulting in increased pressure on the coaches. Consequently, one coach was thrown off the tracks, while another buckled in the middle. Three coaches of the train sustained damage in the incident, they said.

Officials said the incident did not affect rail services and all train operations continue to

run normally.

Workers have detached the damaged coaches from the train. "The work to bring two passenger coaches back on the track is underway with the help of a crane," Yog Nagari railway station manager Surendra Kumar Sharma said, adding, a probe has been ordered to ascertain the exact reason behind the incident.

A large crowd gathered at the railway track after the accident following which the Government Railway Police (GRP) and Railway Protection Force teams controlled the situation.

AGENCIES

From Page 1 Oslo spotlight

India and Nordics

Referring to shared cultural connections, PM Modi noted that the word "Sam-bandh," meaning relations, is common in Indian and Nordic languages, and expressed hope that this would reflect in deeper and more meaningful ties going forward.

The Nordic leaders, in their remarks, reaffirmed their commitment to democracy, a rules-based global order, and reforms in multilateral institutions. They also called for stronger cooperation with India in addressing global challenges, including conflict and disruption.

On global issues, the Prime Minister reiterated India's position in favour of cessation of conflicts in Ukraine and West Asia. He also underlined that India and the Nordic countries share a firm stance against terrorism, with no tolerance for double standards.

The Summit concluded with both sides expressing confidence that the India-Nordic partnership will emerge as a model of shared prosperity, innovation, and sustainable development.

The summit "reflected the expanding scope and growing strength of India's partnership with the Nordic region. The leaders discussed cooperation in sustainability, innovation, clean energy, emerging technologies and more," the prime minister's office said.

He said that today's discussions focused on several aspects, including sustainability, innovation, clean energy, emerging technologies and strengthening cooperation for a peaceful and prosperous future.

"India and the Nordic countries are united by shared democratic values, trust and a common commitment towards human-centric development," he said.

"Rapidly increasing trade and investment have not only contributed to India's growth story, but have also played a very positive role in the Nordic economies, creating thousands of new jobs," he said.

Modi said the two sides have taken some important initiatives to take the relationship to the next level, highlighting the Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement with Norway, Iceland, and other EFTA countries, the India-EU Free Trade Agreement, in which Denmark, Finland, and Sweden are also partners.

Noting that an important pillar of the India-Nordic partnership is extensive research and innovation ties, Modi said the two sides will jointly enhance linkages between universities, labs, and start-up ecosystems to strengthen this.

The five Nordic nations have a combined GDP exceeding USD 1.9 trillion and lead global benchmarks in renewable energy and sustainable ocean governance.

Oslo spotlight

rang out across the room: "Prime Minister Modi, why don't you take some questions from the freest press in the world?"

It was Helle Lyng, a journalist with the local newspaper Dagsavisen, who lobbied that question. She was part of the media contingent covering the visit.

Neither leader broke stride or responded as they walked out. She followed them right up to the lift, until the doors closed. Lyng had a camera running, and she later posted the video on X. "Prime Minister of India, Narendra Modi, would not take my question, I was not expecting him to," she wrote in the caption.

She followed it up with: "Norway has the number one spot on the World Press Freedom Index, India is at 157th, competing with Palestine, Emirates and Cuba. It is our job to question the powers we cooperate with."

The Indian embassy in Norway, responding to Lyng's X post, invited her to attend a news briefing later that evening. The briefing, held late Monday night Oslo time, saw Lyng press Indian officials for the same argument.

Her questions were, "Why should we trust you?" and "Can you promise you will stop the human rights violation that goes on in your country?" She did not detail these questions further.

MEA Secretary (West) Sibi George responded at length. "What is a country? A country today has four elements," he said. "One, population; two, government; third, sovereignty; and fourth, territory. And we are proud that we are a civilisational country of 5,000 years old," he said in a response that ran into several minutes.

He pivoted to India's Covid response as evidence of global trustworthiness. "We didn't hide in a cave, we didn't say we will not save the world. We came out offering a helping hand to the world," he said, pointing to India having supplied vaccines to around 100 countries.

He also cited India's contributions to human civilisation, counting the number zero, chess and yoga, and its diplomatic record as evidence. George mentioned that India had hosted the G20 Summit in 2023, facilitating the African Union's full G20 membership; and organised the Voice of Global South Summits, which brought together 125 countries.

WITH MEDIA REPORTS

Another 90-paise

Friday's increase came after the ruling BJP expanded its electoral footprint by winning three of five state and UT elections, including West Bengal.

Despite the hikes, fuel retailers continue to absorb significant losses. Petroleum Ministry's Joint Secretary, Sujata Sharma said on Monday that the May 15 increase reduced losses by about a fourth, but state-run oil firms were still losing around Rs 750 crore per day.

According to Crisil, oil marketing companies were losing

about Rs 10 per litre on petrol and Rs 13 per litre on diesel even after the earlier hike.

Petrol and diesel prices are now at their highest levels since May 2022. Rates had remained frozen since April 2022 except for a Rs 2-per-litre cut in March 2024 ahead of national elections. Prices vary across states due to local taxes.

Compressed natural gas (CNG) prices have also risen twice within this period, including a Re 1-per-kg increase on Sunday after a Rs 2 hike on May 15 in cities such as Delhi and Mumbai.

Industry officials said the latest revisions appeared calibrated to partially ease pressure on oil companies without triggering a sharp inflation shock, though they acknowledged the increases would add to price pressures.

India's retail inflation accelerated to 3.48 per cent in April from 3.40 per cent in March, while wholesale inflation climbed to a 42-month high of 8.3 per cent, driven largely by higher fuel and energy costs.

Opposition Congress party sharpened its attack on the government over rising fuel prices and inflation, warning that the latest increases were only the start of broader price pressures facing consumers.

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Rupee crashes

Rupee, Asia's worst-performing currency, has lost Rs 2.48 or 2.64 per cent versus the greenback in the past eight sessions since the closing level of 94.22 recorded on May 7.

Forex traders attributed the domestic currency's steep fall to rising crude oil prices and global supply chain disruptions due to the closure of the Strait of Hormuz.

At the interbank foreign exchange market, the rupee opened at 96.38 against the US dollar and touched the intraday high of 96.27 during the session.

At the end of the session, the Indian currency was quoted at its historic low of 96.70 against the dollar, recording a steep fall of 50 paise from its previous closing level.

On Monday, the Indian rupee settled at 96.20 against the US dollar.

Putin set

President Putin last visited India in December 2025 for the 23rd India-Russia Annual Summit.

Earlier this month, Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov attended a two-day conclave of the BRICS member states in New Delhi.

BRICS, originally comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa, expanded in 2024 to include Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, and the United Arab Emirates, with Indonesia joining in 2025.

The BRICS has emerged as an influential grouping as it brings together 11 major emerging economies of the world, representing around 49.5 per cent of the global population, around 40 per cent of the global GDP and around 26 per cent of the global trade.

Meanwhile, President Putin arrived in Beijing on Tuesday

night on a two-day state visit for talks with his Chinese counterpart Xi Jinping, days after US leader Donald Trump travelled to China.

Xi and Putin will exchange views on bilateral ties, cooperation in various fields, as well as international and regional issues of mutual interest, the Chinese Foreign Ministry said.

This is Putin's 25th visit to China, foreign ministry spokesperson Guo Jiakun told a media briefing here on Monday, emphasising close strategic ties between Russia and China as well as strong friendship and rapport between the two leaders.

"The two sides will take this visit as an opportunity to continue to promote the development of China-Russia relations to a higher level, which will inject greater stability and positive energy into the world," Guo said.

Since Xi took power in 2012, the two leaders have met dozens of times, frequently referring to each other as "dear friend" and emphasising mutual trust.

Their ties have strengthened through cooperation in trade, energy, security, and efforts to counter Western influence and observers view the Xi-Putin relationship as one of the most significant political partnerships in contemporary global affairs.

Significantly, Putin is visiting Beijing days after Trump's three-day trip here from May 14 to 16, during which he held close-door talks with Xi on a host of global and bilateral issues.

They were expected to exchange views on Trump's visit to Beijing.

The key focus of Trump's visit to China was the blockade of the Strait of Hormuz by Iran, which has caused a serious energy crisis all over the world, as well as the American seizure of Iranian ports.

Iran is a close strategic ally of both Russia and China, which are also its major arms suppliers. China imports 90 per cent of Iranian oil, disregarding US sanctions.

Capital bakes at 45°C

Delhi is expected to witness another significant rise in electricity demand this summer. According to SLDC projections, against the all-time high peak demand of 8,656 MW recorded in 2025, Delhi's peak power demand is expected to cross 9,000 MW this year.

In the summer of 2025, the highest peak demand was recorded at 8,442 MW on June 12.

The power discoms have made advanced preparations to tackle the soaring demand of electricity in the national capital.

A BSES spokesperson said its discoms -- BRPL and BYPL -- are geared up to ensure reliable power supply to more than 53 lakh consumers and nearly 2.25 crore residents across south, west, east and central Delhi.

Long-term purchase tie-ups, banking arrangements with other states and deployment of advanced technologies such as AI and ML-based demand forecasting have been employed to maintain uninterrupted supply, he said.

Around 2,670 MW of green power will play a key role in ensuring reliable electricity supply during the summer months

in BSES areas. Solar power is expected to contribute about 840 MW, hydro around 572 MW and wind nearly 500 MW. Pumped Storage Plants (PSP) will provide around 312 MW, he said.

Tata Power Delhi Distribution Limited (TPDDL) supplied the season's peak demand of 2,220 MW to date seamlessly across its network in north Delhi areas, its spokesperson said.

Poor air

"Accordingly, the CAQM sub-committee on GRAP decided to invoke all actions as per stage I of the extant GRAP with immediate effect in the entire NCR," the official said.

Under GRAP-1, restrictions are placed, such as banning the use of coal and firewood as fuel in tandoors in hotels, restaurants, and open eateries, and allowing diesel generators only in emergency or essential situations.

MP0ST

TMC's Falta

In a social media statement, the TMC reiterated that the party had no role in the decision. "The decision taken by Jahangir Khan to withdraw from the Falta re-poll is his personal decision and not that of the party," it said.

The party further alleged that more than 100 of its workers in Falta had been arrested since the election results were declared on May 4. "Some eventually succumbed to the pressure and chose to step away from the field. We strongly condemn this," the statement added.

Sources said that during a meeting at Kalighat, some TMC MLAs questioned party chief Mamata Banerjee and national general secretary Abhishek Banerjee over why disciplinary action had not been initiated against Khan.

Meanwhile, a single-judge bench of the Calcutta High Court granted interim protection to Khan from coercive police action, including arrest, until completion of the re-poll process and declaration of results.

Five FIRs have been lodged against Khan — one on May 5, three on May 10 and another on May 15.

The Falta re-poll is scheduled for May 21 after the Election Commission ordered fresh polling in all 285 booths following allegations of irregularities during the April 29 Assembly election phase. Counting will take place on May 24.

Khalid

of his uncle only and not now after such a long time. Therefore, the court does not find this reason to be just," the judge said. Opposing Khalid's bail plea, Special Public Prosecutor Anirudh Mishra told the court that the accused has five sisters and a father who can help his mother pre and post surgery.

"The surgery is not a serious one and is just a minor surgery, in which only local anaesthesia is given, and as such, again, there is no need for the accused to attend to his mother," Mishra said.

Taking note of the prosecu-

tion's submissions, the court said Khalid himself had stated that he has five sisters and that his father is also available to take care of his mother.

"Further, as said by the prosecution, the surgery is very simple, that is, just for the removal of lumps, and there seems to be no actual requirement of help from the side of the applicant," the court said while denying bail to Khalid.

Khalid is an accused in the conspiracy case linked to the February 2020 communal riots in northeast Delhi.

He was booked under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA) and provisions of the IPC for allegedly being a mastermind of the 2020 riots that left 53 people dead and more than 700 injured.

The researcher and scholar was arrested in the case on September 13, 2020.

Khalid's first regular bail plea was dismissed by the court on March 24, 2022, following which the Delhi High Court rejected his appeal against the order on October 18 of the same year.

Activists Sharjeel Imam, Khalid Saifi and former Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) councillor Tahir Hussain, among others, were booked for their alleged involvement in the larger conspiracy case, which is being investigated by the Delhi Police's Special Cell.

Rape accused

The woman further alleged that she was threatened with dire consequences if she reported the incident to police.

Based on the complaint, an FIR was registered at Muradnagar Police Station on August 8, 2025. After initially evading arrest, Prajapati was apprehended on August 11 following a police manhunt during which a reward of Rs 25,000 had been announced on him. He was granted bail and released on May 17 after spending nearly nine months in jail.

Reacting strongly to the celebrations following Prajapati's release on bail, Samajwadi Party Chief Akhilesh Yadav launched a sharp attack on the Uttar Pradesh government and the ruling BJP.

In a post on X, Yadav said the public reception given to a rape accused reflected the "true character" of the BJP and questioned the message such celebrations send regarding women's safety and dignity.

"Nothing can be more reprehensible than the way in which the 'rape accused' senior official of that very brigade — which the Chief Minister has only recently praised — has been welcomed with flowers and garlands after getting bail," Yadav said.

He further alleged that such incidents expose the ruling party's "double standards" on women's issues.

NEET leak

Officials believe that the students came in contact with the racket through Manisha Waghmare, a Pune-based beautician arrested earlier in the case. She acted as an intermediary connecting students and parents with members of the paper leak syndicate.

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

CRUCIAL MEETING BEARS NO FRUIT

AIADMK cold war deepens as Palaniswami, rebels dig in heels

OUR CORRESPONDENT

CHENNAI: AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K Palaniswami on Tuesday held a crucial meeting of senior office-bearers here to strengthen his position in the party while rebels refused to budge and continued to pose a challenge to his leadership.

While Palaniswami, a day after extending an olive branch to rebels to come forward and talk to resolve issues, held a 2-hour long meeting of loyalists at party headquarters, he did not accept the demand of the dissenters to convene the general council.

Also, none from the rebel group, led by senior leaders CVe Shanmugam and SP Velumani responded positively to Palaniswami's invite to join hands and not become fireflies.

Emerging from the Palaniswami held meeting,



AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K Palaniswami during the floor test

PTI

Highlights

» Palaniswami, a day after extending an olive branch to rebels to come forward and talk to resolve issues, held a 2-hour long meeting of loyalists at party headquarters

» Also, none from the rebel group, led by senior leaders CVe Shanmugam and SP Velumani responded positively to Palaniswami's invite to join hands and not become fireflies

senior leader O S Manian said "constructive debate" was held adding nothing was spoken on convening the general council.

According to party leader B V Ramana, a Palaniwami loyalist, the meeting was attended by about 80 district secretaries. All the office bearers and cadres "solidly stood" with Palaniswami, and the party would work out a strategy to emerge victorious, he said.

"Over 80 district secretar-

ies attended the meeting. A few could not attend as they were not able to arrive at the party headquarters on time," Ramana told reporters, emerging from the meeting.

Manian said the meeting did not discuss rebel leader Vijayabaskar's alleged claim of "obtaining signatures" from functionaries to urge the leadership to conduct a general council meeting to discuss the poll debacle and take a "good

decision."

The breakaway group raised the pitch for convening the party general council to introspect AIADMK's successive defeat in the elections since 2019.

Shanmugam, speaking to reporters, slammed Palaniswami as he, on the one hand, requested the dissenting leaders to come for talks and at the same time he continued to remove office-bearers --31

district secretaries-- from their positions.

Shanmugam, Velumani and Vijayabaskar are among those who have been stripped of their party posts.

Such a course of action was not only valid but also was nothing but a threat and intimidation.

Shanmugam said he and his supporters were willing for a discussion but could not accept being labeled as "traitors" for expressing their opinion.

The AIADMK's continuous defeat at the hustings corroded the party's vote bank.

"This is a big threat to the organisation. We have been saying that the reasons for the defeat should be reviewed and discussed. Our plea for convening the general council after the defeat in the 2024 polls was rejected," Shanmugam along with Velumani and Vijayabaskar, reacting to the day's development at the party office.

'Economic storm ahead': Rahul targets PM over 'austerity hypocrisy'

'PM Modi not heeding own austerity appeal'

BISWAJEET BANERJEE



Rahul Gandhi addresses a gathering during the 'Gram Vikas Samvad' programme, at Bachhrawan, in Raebareilly

PTI

RAE BAREILY: Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi on Tuesday launched a sharp attack on Prime Minister Narendra Modi during his visit to his parliamentary constituency Rae Bareilly, alleging that the country was heading towards a severe economic crisis that would hit youth, farmers and small traders the hardest.

Addressing people in Rae Bareilly, Rahul said an "economic storm" was approaching and warned that Uttar Pradesh would face a major economic shock because of the changes made in the country's economic structure by the Modi government.

He said the impact of the crisis would not be felt by industrialists such as Gautam Adani and Mukesh Ambani or by the Prime Minister, but by ordinary citizens, including workers, farmers, youths and small businessmen.

"Very difficult times are coming. Instead of taking action, the Prime Minister is advising people not to travel abroad, while he himself is travelling around the world," Rahul said.

The Congress leader also attacked the Centre over rising fuel prices and inflation. He said petrol prices were continuously increasing and inflation was "touching the sky," while the government remained

indifferent to public concerns.

Taking a swipe at the PM, Rahul said Modi tells people not to buy gold, to purchase electric vehicles and avoid foreign travel, but then goes abroad himself. He claimed that the coming economic crisis would be unprecedented and impossible to stop.

During the interaction, Rahul Gandhi also sought to strengthen his emotional connect with voters in Rae Bareilly. He thanked the people for supporting him and said his relationship with the constituency was like that of a family.

"You can call me wherever you go and I will stand with you. You had demanded a marriage hall and we ensured it was provided. Next time there is a wedding here, do invite me," he said.

Rahul is scheduled to meet people during a Jan Darshan programme on May 20 and will also unveil a statue of freedom fighter Veera Pasi before leaving for Ameti.

SP-Congress alliance here to stay, claims Akhilesh Yadav

LUCKNOW: Samajwadi Party president Akhilesh Yadav on Tuesday said the alliance with its partners would continue in future elections, asserting that the formula will be "victory not seats."

Speaking at an event organised by Amar Ujala newspaper, when asked whether Congress leader Rahul Gandhi and he would be seen campaigning together in the coming elections, Yadav said his party has vast experience in running alliances and always ensured that its allies benefited from the arrangement.

"We have entered into many alliances. We have experience of alliances and the Samajwadi Party has always ensured gains



Akhilesh Yadav offers 'prasad' to people on the occasion of Bada Mangal, in Lucknow, on Tuesday

PTI

for its allies. We have never betrayed anyone. The alliance that exists today will continue ahead," Yadav said.

He said that future alliance discussions would not revolve around bargaining for seats but around ensuring electoral success.

"There will not be a ques-

tion of seats in the alliance. Even during the Lok Sabha elections, I had said that the issue was not about seats, the issue was about victory. The same formula will work again. The question will not be of seats, the question will be of victory," he said.

The remarks assume significance amid continued discussions over opposition unity and possible seat-sharing arrangements for the assembly election in Uttar Pradesh due next year.

Asked about the face of opposition, Yadav said it would be inflation, rising price of fuel, Agniveer youths, farmers, labourers and also 69,000 shiksha mitra, who did not get a permanent job.

MPOST

'India must control energy sovereignty': Cong

NEW DELHI: The Congress slammed the BJP-led Centre on Tuesday over the second fuel-price hike in a week, saying India must take control of its energy sovereignty and demanding a clear action plan on the rates of petrol and diesel.

Congress leaders Mallikarjun Kharge, KC Venugopal and Shaktisinh Gohil criticised the Centre over the rise in fuel prices that is affecting the common man.

Kharge claimed that Modi has proved to be a failure on the economic front and said the Centre should reflect on its failures and seek solutions by taking everyone along.

His remarks came after petrol and diesel prices were hiked by about 90 paise per litre on Tuesday, marking the second increase in fuel rates in less

Cong alleges ONGC mismanagement

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Congress leader and Rajya Sabha MP Shaktisinh Gohil on Tuesday launched a sharp attack on the Narendra Modi government, alleging systematic mismanagement at Oil and Natural Gas Corporation (ONGC) that, he claimed, led to an annual loss of 3.695 million metric tonnes in domestic oil and gas production. Gohil alleged that water injection

levels — a critical process for maintaining well health and sustaining output — had been reduced by 20 to 70 per cent across ONGC's three major fields: Mumbai High, Neelam and Heera, which together account for 59 per cent of India's domestic oil and gas production. "Water injection at Mumbai High was reduced by 53 per cent, at Neelam by 42 per cent, and at Heera by 78 per cent," he claimed.

than a week since State-run oil firms ended a nearly-four-year freeze on revisions.

"Just four days after the price hike, the Modi government has once again increased

the prices of petrol and diesel. Having set the stage, preaching about savings while shifting the burden of their failures onto the public -- this effort is in full swing," Kharge alleged in

Vijay writes to PM over fertiliser supply to TN

CHENNAI: Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay on Tuesday urged Prime Minister Narendra Modi to ensure an uninterrupted supply of fertilisers, especially urea and DAP, to the state for the 2026 Kharif season. Seeking the early intervention of the Prime Minister, Vijay said necessary instructions should be issued to ensure that the shortfall in fertilisers was made good immediately.

"Kindly instruct the authorities concerned to supply the required quantity to meet the demand for the rest of Kharif, 2026, which is 3.83 lakh MT of urea, 1.05 lakh MT of DAP and 0.83 lakh MT of MOP," the chief minister said in a letter addressed to Modi.

Stating that there was a shortfall in the supply of fertilisers by the manufacturers during April and May 2026, Vijay said Tamil Nadu was an agrarian state and agriculture provided livelihood to more than 40 per cent of the population.

The Gross Cultivated Area is 62.25 lakh hectares and the net sown area is 48.27 lakh hectares. About 92 per cent of the total farmers are small marginal farmers who possess land holdings less than 2 hectares. "Tamil Nadu is endowed with 3 per cent of the water resources in India and has diversified cropping system which includes paddy, millets, oilseeds, cotton, sugarcane, vegetables, flowers, fruits, medicinal and aromatic crops, spices and condiments, plantation crops etc.," the CM said.

During his review of the agriculture department, it emerged that fertiliser manufacturers have not supplied fertilisers as per the Government of India supply plan for April and May 2026. A total quantity of 39,001 MT of urea, 28,607 MT of Diammonium phosphate (DAP) and 24,235 MT of Muriate of Potash (MOP) was not supplied in the last two months as per the supply plan and there has been a shortfall in the supply, he said.

MPOST

Ex-Uttarakhand CM BC Khanduri dies; President, PM express grief

DEHRADUN: Former Uttarakhand Chief Minister and senior BJP leader Bhuvan Chandra Khanduri died at a private hospital here on Tuesday following prolonged illness. He was 91.

The veteran leader breathed his last at around 11 am, his daughter and Uttarakhand Assembly Speaker Ritu Khanduri Bhushan said.

Khanduri is survived by his wife Aruna, son Manish, and daughter Ritu Khanduri Bhushan. The former chief minister was suffering from age-related ailments and underwent frequent hospitalisations recently.

Before entering politics, Khanduri retired from the Indian Army as a major



He served as the CM of the hill state twice

PTI

general. Popularly known as 'General Sahab', he earned a reputation as a disciplined and strict administrator.

Khanduri served as the CM of the hill state twice. He first took office in 2007 after the BJP won the assembly polls.

President Droupadi Murmu condoled Khanduri's demise, saying his commitment to good governance and public welfare will always be remembered.

"The news of the demise of former chief minister of Uttarakhand and former Union minister, Major General (Retd) B C Khanduri ji, is extremely sad. After rendering exemplary service in the Indian Army, he set an example of honest, simple, transparent, and development-oriented politics in public service," she said.

Expressing condolences, Prime Minister Modi said Khanduri made valuable contributions to both the armed forces and the political sphere.

MPOST

How a dramatic last-minute twist shaped BC Khanduri's political journey forever

Veteran contributed to national defence in the 1962, 1965, and 1971 historic wars

DEHRADUN: The rise of former two-time Uttarakhand chief minister late Major General (Retd) Bhuvan Chandra Khanduri to a political heavyweight in the BJP began with a minor shift in the local political landscape in 1991.

Khanduri had earlier disclosed that he had rejected the Pauri Garhwal Lok Sabha seat initially as he did not want to fight the election against his cousin -- Vijay Bahuguna -- who was likely to be in the fray on a Congress ticket.

However, the Congress did not field Bahuguna from the seat at the last moment and as a result, Khanduri filed his nomination as the BJP candidate -- beginning his expansive political career both on the national and the state level.

The veteran leader passed away at the age of 91 here on Tuesday.

Born on October 1, 1934, Khanduri studied science at Allahabad University from 1951 to 1953. He was commissioned into the Corps of Engi-



Uttarakhand CM Pushkar Singh Dhami pays tributes to former former CM Major General (Retd) BC Khanduri on Tuesday

neers of the Indian Army in 1954. He studied Civil Engineering at the College of Military Engineering in Pune from 1957 to 1959.

He underwent training at the Defence Services Staff College in Wellington and Reserve Staff College in England. He attended the Institute of Defence Management and the Institute of Public Administration to enhance leadership skills. The veteran contributed to national defence in the 1962, 1965, and 1971 historic wars.

He commanded an Engineer Regiment in the Samba sector during the 1971 Indo-Pak War.

Khanduri also served as director of Management Studies at Army Headquarters and commanded an Engineer Brigade at Meerut. He further worked as the chief engineer in Sili-guri and held positions of the deputy and additional military secretary.

The Government of India conferred the Ati Vishisht Seva Medal upon him on January 26, 1982. He retired as a Major General in 1991 after over three decades of military service.

Moving on to his political career, the army veteran contested his first election in 1991 and saw the electorate siding

with him, giving a wide berth to senior Congress leader Satpal Maharaj that year. This initial victory was crucial for the BJP leader, as he went on to represent the Pauri Garhwal seat in 1998, 1999, 2004 and 2014. In the 1996 elections, he lost the seat to Satpal Maharaj -- only to wrench it back again in 1998.

The BJP appointed the former army engineer, popularly known as 'General Sahab', as the chief whip of its parliamentary party in 1992. Later, he also served as the vice-president of BJP's Uttar Pradesh unit.

After his return to Lok

He appealed to all communities to shun violence and help the government

IMPHAL: Manipur Chief Minister Y Khemhand Singh on Tuesday said that the state government is making all efforts to subdue the tense situation arising out of the abduction of several persons in the hill districts of the state, an official statement said.

Singh made the remark during a meeting with a delegation of the Liangmai Naga groups which urged Singh to rescue the six men from the community, who had allegedly been abducted.

More than 38 people were abducted and held hostage by armed groups in Kangpokpi and Senapati districts on May 13, hours after three church leaders were shot dead in an ambush in Kangpokpi. Thirty

leader told Singh that even if the six men who hailed from Konsakhul village are dead, their bodies should be handed over to their families for the last rites, it said.

The tribal leaders also demanded that the chief minister deploy police forces in the vulnerable Liangmai villages in Kangpokpi district.

Singh informed the delegation that the police and CRPF personnel are conducting combing operations in suspected areas to trace the six missing men, it said.

Appealing for calm at this juncture, the chief minister said, "The state government is making all-out efforts to subdue the tense situation and bring peace in the areas."

A Liangmai community

MPOST

CPI(M), BJP clash over 'Vande Mataram' rendition

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM: The CPI(M) on Tuesday criticised the full rendition of "Vande Mataram" at the Congress-led UDF Cabinet swearing-in ceremony in Kerala, terming it an "incorrect step" and saying it is "inappropriate in a pluralistic society." The BJP hit out at the CPI(M), accusing the Communists of "insulting" the national song in order to "appease radical vote-bank forces such as Jamaat-e-Islami and SDPI."

Distancing itself from the row, sources in the new government said they had no role in the programme, as it was fully organised by the Lok Bhavan.

A day after the swearing-in ceremony of the V D Sathesanan-led Cabinet, the CPI(M) state secretariat said the Congress Working Committee had, as early as 1937, taken the view that singing all parts of "Vande Mataram" was not suitable for a pluralistic society, leading to the removal of certain portions.

It noted that the Constituent Assembly later clarified in 1950 that only the first eight lines of the approved version should be treated as the national song.

The party argued that some portions of the song represent religious beliefs and that using the full version in official ceremonies goes against India's plural traditions. It said the Cabinet event "reversed that position" by including the omitted portions.

The CPI(M) also pointed out that similar full renditions were not performed even in BJP-ruled West Bengal during swearing-in ceremonies, suggesting Kerala's move was unusual.

AGENCIES

Nation Briefs

CONG FLAGS 'DISCREPANCY' IN BOARD MARKS, MH-CET SCORES OF TOP-RANKERS

MUMBAI: The Congress on Tuesday alleged serious irregularities in the last year's Maharashtra Common Entrance Test (MH-CET), claiming that students with very low marks in Class 10 and 12 board examinations secured near-perfect scores in the test conducted for engineering and other technical courses. The CET Cell of the state government, however, denied the allegations of irregularities, and maintained that the process was completely transparent. At least 22 students with low scores in board examinations were among the top performers in MH-CET 2025-26, said Congress leader Sachin Sawant, claiming that the scale of irregularities was similar to that of the NEET-UG paper leak case.

SHIVRAJ SAYS FERTILISERS NOT EASILY AVAILABLE IN INTERNATIONAL MARKET

BHUBANESWAR: Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan on Tuesday acknowledged challenges in procuring fertilisers from the international market, urging states and farmers to increasingly adopt organic farming as an alternative. Addressing the Eastern Zonal Agriculture Conference in Bhubaneswar, Chouhan said the Centre was making every possible effort to ensure fertiliser availability for farmers despite global supply constraints. "I have no hesitation in admitting that fertilisers are not easily available in the international market. The government is trying hard to procure fertilisers for farmers," he said.

mp

EDITORIAL

LEGAL CLOSURE

For nearly two years, the allegations surrounding the Adani Group cast a shadow far beyond boardrooms and stock markets. They became part of a larger global conversation about corporate governance, regulatory power and the rise of Indian conglomerates on the world stage. When U.S. authorities first unveiled allegations linked to securities fraud and bribery involving Gautam Adani and his nephew Sagar Adani, the headlines carried the weight of inevitability. To many observers, the narrative appeared settled long before the courts could arrive at a conclusion. Yet the dramatic decision by the U.S. Department of Justice to permanently drop all criminal charges against the Adanis has now altered the direction of that story entirely. The dismissal “with prejudice” — meaning the case cannot be reopened — is not a routine procedural footnote. It is a significant legal and symbolic development that has implications extending well beyond one business group.

The outcome is particularly striking because such dismissals are relatively uncommon in high-profile American criminal proceedings. Prosecutors typically pursue cases only when they believe evidence can withstand prolonged scrutiny. The fact that the Department of Justice ultimately concluded it would no longer devote resources to the prosecution indicates that the allegations failed to sustain the legal threshold required for continuation. Equally important is the context in which this happened. The criminal case had emerged at a time when the Adani Group was aggressively expanding across infrastructure, energy, logistics and international markets. The investigations were therefore interpreted not merely as legal scrutiny but as a potential threat to the credibility of one of India’s most visible corporate success stories. The closure of the case now marks a sharp reversal in perception and restores significant reputational ground for the group.

What makes the development even more consequential is the legal argument that appears to have shaped the eventual outcome. Adani’s defence team consistently challenged what it described as an excessive extraterritorial application of U.S. securities laws. Their contention was simple yet powerful: the defendants were Indian, the projects were in India, the alleged conduct occurred within India and the securities in question were not traded on American exchanges. In essence, the defence questioned whether American prosecutors had stretched their jurisdiction beyond reasonable limits in an attempt to pursue conduct that lacked substantial U.S. linkage. Over time, that argument began gaining attention even among legal experts and former regulators in the United States. The eventual collapse of the criminal proceedings suggests that these jurisdictional concerns could not be ignored indefinitely.

The case also highlights a larger reality about the treatment of emerging-market corporations within the global financial ecosystem. The moment allegations surface against a large non-Western conglomerate, financial markets and sections of the international commentary often move swiftly from suspicion to assumption. Reputational damage is inflicted almost instantly, regardless of whether allegations are eventually proven. In the Adani case, the fallout was enormous. Investor confidence was shaken, expansion plans came under pressure and critics portrayed the controversy as evidence of structural weaknesses within Indian corporate governance itself. Yet the eventual withdrawal of criminal charges serves as a reminder that legal systems are expected to operate on evidence rather than narrative momentum. It also underlines the dangers of allowing financial speculation, geopolitical undertones and media amplification to shape conclusions before due process has run its course.

At the same time, the broader resolution of multiple U.S. investigations reflects a more complex picture than either celebration or condemnation alone would suggest. The SEC settlement and the OFAC settlement involving LPG imports did involve substantial financial payments by the Adani Group, even though wrongdoing was neither admitted nor established in criminal court. Critics will therefore argue that the group cannot claim total vindication. That criticism is valid to an extent. However, global corporate settlements are often pragmatic legal resolutions rather than admissions of criminal guilt. What ultimately matters most in this case is that the central criminal fraud prosecution — the most damaging and potentially destabilising component of the controversy — has collapsed entirely. For the Adani Group, that distinction is enormously significant because criminal allegations carry consequences far beyond monetary penalties; they shape global trust, access to capital and long-term strategic positioning.

The larger significance of this episode lies in what it reveals about India’s changing place in the world economy. Indian conglomerates today are no longer confined to domestic markets. They are raising global capital, acquiring strategic overseas assets and competing directly with some of the world’s largest multinational corporations. With that rise comes heightened scrutiny, geopolitical friction and legal contestation. The Adani case became, in many ways, a test of whether Indian corporate ambition could withstand coordinated financial, reputational and regulatory pressure from some of the world’s most powerful institutions. The group’s ability to survive that pressure without structural collapse will be viewed by many in India as evidence of growing institutional resilience and corporate confidence. The broader lesson is not that corporations should be immune from scrutiny — accountability and transparency remain essential — but that scrutiny itself must remain grounded in evidence, consistency and fairness. The closure of the U.S. criminal case against Gautam Adani therefore marks more than the end of a legal battle. It signals the arrival of Indian corporate power into a far more contested and politically charged global arena, where economic influence and geopolitical narratives increasingly intersect.

GLOBAL SYNERGY



GIORGIA MELONI & NARENDRA MODI

THE WRITERS ARE PRESIDENT OF THE COUNCIL OF MINISTERS OF THE ITALIAN REPUBLIC AND PRIME MINISTER OF THE REPUBLIC OF INDIA, RESPECTIVELY

The partnership combines India’s scale, innovation ecosystem and digital infrastructure with Italy’s industrial expertise, design excellence and technological capabilities

INCLUSIVE INNOVATION



RANJANA CHOPRA

THE WRITER IS THE SECRETARY, MINISTRY OF TRIBAL AFFAIRS, GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

The Ministry presented a range of AI-enabled platforms built on a simple but powerful belief: that language is not a barrier to be overcome but an identity to be celebrated

Trade Partners to Strategic Allies

From AI to energy corridors, India and Italy are shaping a partnership designed for resilience, innovation and long-term global influence

The relationship between India and Italy has now reached a decisive stage. In recent years, our ties have expanded with unprecedented momentum, evolving from a cordial friendship into a special strategic partnership grounded in the values of freedom and democracy, and a common vision for the future.

At a time when the international system is undergoing a profound change, the partnership between Italy and India is guided by regular exchanges at higher political and institutional levels, and is gaining a new and higher dimension that combines our economic dynamism, societal creativity, and millennia-old civilisational wisdom. Our cooperation mirrors our shared awareness that prosperity and security in the 21st century will be shaped by the ability of nations to innovate, manage energy transitions, and strengthen strategic sovereignty. To this end, we have committed to deepening and diversifying our bilateral relationship with a view to pursuing new objectives and pooling our complementary strengths. We aim to forge a powerful synergy between Italian design, manufacturing excellence, and world-class supercomputers—reflecting Italy’s position as an industrial powerhouse—and India’s rapid economic growth, engineering talent, scale, and innovation and entrepreneurial ecosystem with over 100 unicorns and 200,000 start-ups. This is not a simple integration, but a co-creation of value where our respective industrial strengths amplify one another.

The Free Trade Agreement between the European Union and India paves the way for increased trade and investment in both directions. We want to reach and exceed the Euro 20 billion target for trade between Italy and India by 2029, with a focus on defence & aerospace, clean technologies, machinery, automotive components, chemicals, pharmaceuticals, textiles, agri-food, tourism and more.

“Made in Italy” has always been synonymous with excellence worldwide, and today it finds a natural synergy with the high-quality goals of the “Make in India” initiative. In this context, the growing interest of Italian businesses in the production for India and the increasing presence of Indian industries in Italy, numbering over 1000 from both sides now, is a positive sign that will strengthen the integration of our supply chains.



India and Italy are shaping a partnership where technology serves human dignity

Technological innovation lies at the very heart of our partnership. The coming decades will be shaped by a technological revolution of unmeasurable scope, marked by advances in sectors such as Artificial Intelligence, quantum computing, advanced manufacturing, critical minerals, and digital infrastructure. India’s dynamic innovation ecosystem, coupled with a highly skilled professional talent pool, and Italy’s advanced industrial capabilities, make our cooperation in the above sectors both natural and strategic. The growing partnership between our Universities and Research Centres will support this. India’s Digital Public Infrastructure is already finding resonance with a large number of countries, particularly in the Global South. Artificial Intelligence, in particular, is already impacting our societies and the global economy. Italy and India have long been collaborating to ensure that AI development is responsible and human-centred. From this perspective, India and Italy also see AI as a powerful instrument for inclusive development, especially for the Global South, where digital public infrastructure and accessible, multilingual technologies can bridge divides rather than deepen them. Building on India’s vision of MANAV—putting human at the centre of technology—and Italy’s leadership in promoting a human-centric ‘algor-ethics’ rooted in its humanist tradition, our partnership seeks to ensure that AI acts as a catalyst for social empowerment. Our approach combines India’s digital scale with Italy’s ethical and industrial expertise, ensuring technology serves human

dignity. By sharing best practices in secure digital cooperation, capacity-building and resilient cyber infrastructure, we aim to create an open, trustworthy and equitable digital space in which every nation can shape and benefit from AI. This perspective forms the core of Italy’s G7 Presidency and the outcomes of the AI Impact Summit 2026, held in New Delhi. Conceiving AI as a tool created by humans for humans means firmly asserting that technology cannot replace individuals or undermine their fundamental rights, nor be used to manipulate public debate or alter democratic processes. Our approach to defending freedom and human dignity in an increasingly interconnected world hinges on this very challenge.

Our cooperation also covers the space sector. India’s impressive advancements in space exploration and satellite technology, together with Italy’s aerospace engineering excellence, offer significant opportunities for joint initiatives and next-generation technology development.

Security and stability remain essential to ensuring nations’ prosperity. Italy and India intend to further strengthen their cooperation in sectors such as defence, security and strategic technologies. Our collaboration will help ensure the security of critical maritime routes, strengthen resilience in the face of threats, such as terrorism, international criminal networks, drug trafficking, cyber-crimes and human trafficking.

Energy is another key pillar of our partnership. The global transition towards diversified energy sources requires innovative, investment, and cooperation.

India and Italy are collaborating from renewable energy to hydrogen technologies, and from smart grids to resilient infrastructure. While India’s push for becoming a hub for Green Hydrogen exports offers immense potential, it perfectly complements Italy’s advanced technology in renewable infrastructure and its strategic role as an energy gateway for Europe. Our collaboration along with other countries in key India-led initiatives—International Solar Alliance (ISA), Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure (CDRI) and Global Biofuels Alliance (GBA)—is also important in this context.

Physical, digital and human connectivity is the thread that weaves us together. Both India and Italy are located at the very heart of two crucial hubs of the global economy, the Indo-Pacific and the Mediterranean—regions that cannot be viewed as separate spheres, but instead as increasingly interconnected spaces. As a matter of fact, we are witnessing the emergence of what might be termed the Indo-Mediterranean, an important corridor for trade, technology, energy, data and ideas tying the Indian Ocean to Europe. It is precisely within this interconnected space that our bond naturally evolves into a special strategic partnership—one that bridges two continents and shapes new global dynamics.

In this context, the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor (IMEC) represents a vision aimed at connecting our regions through modern transport and infrastructure, digital networks, energy systems, and resilient supply chains. India and Italy are also committed to working together with other partners to make this vision a reality.

We can address our shared challenges by drawing upon the profound partnership and the enduring cultural ties between our nations. Within Indian culture, the concept of “Dharma” evokes the sense of responsibility that must guide our actions, whilst the principle of “Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam”—the world is one family—resonates powerfully in this interconnected digital age. Such values find a natural echo in Italy’s humanist tradition, rooted in the Renaissance, which highlights the dignity of each individual and the power of culture to unite peoples and societies. Our shared vision, therefore, aims to lay the foundation for a strong and forward-looking India-Italy Partnership with our people at the centre.

Tech in Service of Tribal Dignity

Digital governance, tribal language AI tools, and scientific innovation are bringing dignity and opportunity while preserving tribal identity, culture and traditional knowledge systems

In the forests, hills, and remote habitations that stretch across our country, a quiet yet consequential transformation is underway. Tribal communities, long awaiting their rightful place at the center of India’s development story, are today emerging as active architects of the nation’s progress. This is the spirit that underlies Janjatiya Garima Utsav: a national celebration of a journey towards Viksit Bharat, where progress is not a privilege of geography or circumstance, but a right belonging equally to every citizen.

The Scale of the Ambition

To appreciate why technology has become indispensable to tribal development, one must first appreciate the magnitude of the challenge. Pradhan Mantri Janjati Adivasi Nyaya Maha Abhiyan (PM-JANMAN), Dharti Aaba Janjatiya Gram Utkarsh Abhiyan (DAJGUA), the National Sickle Cell Anaemia Elimination Mission, and related initiatives cover more than 63,000 villages across 549 districts and 2,911 blocks in 30 States and Union Territories, benefiting more than 5.5 crore tribal citizens. With special focus on Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTGs), these efforts aim to ensure saturation coverage of essential services such as housing, drinking water, sanitation, education, healthcare, connectivity, and livelihoods. Reaching every family across such diverse and expansive terrain demands system that are data-driven, connected, and responsive and that is precisely what we are building.

Janjatiya Garima Utsav this year is organised around four thematic weeks, which together reflect the full arc of tribal development. The opening theme, “Technology as a Development Driver,” captures how digital systems, science, and innovation are helping extend governance and opportunity to some of India’s remotest communities. At the heart of this vision lies a simple principle: development must reach the last mile while remaining deeply respectful of tribal languages, cultures, heritage, and traditional knowledge systems.

Technology in Service of Tribal Dignity

The most vivid illustration of what technology can accomplish when directed with purpose is BIRSA 101 – India’s first indigenous CRISPR-based gene therapy for sickle cell disease. Sickle cell disease has long posed a significant



From BIRSA 101 to AI-powered tribal language platforms, India is attempting to make innovation more humane, inclusive and accessible

health challenge for tribal populations, and India is now answering that challenge with advanced science rooted in equity and accessibility. The Ministry of Tribal Affairs has extended financial assistance to support research, clinical trial infrastructure, and technology transfer in collaboration with the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR), CSIR-Institute of Genomics and Integrative Biology (IGIB), and Serum Institute of India Pvt. Ltd. A recent seminar at CSIR-IGIB brought together scientists, policymakers and Sickle cell warriors, reflecting both the scientific progress and the human urgency behind the efforts.

The shared goal is clear: to develop an affordable, one-time curative treatment that can reach every tribal family in need. BIRSA 101 is not merely a medical milestone. It is a declaration that India’s most advanced science will serve its most deserving communities.

This conviction runs deeper than a single initiative. Efforts such as the Traditional Knowledge Digital Library (TKDL) and Ayurgenomics demonstrate how modern technology can help document, validate, and preserve the rich medicinal and ecological knowledge long safeguarded by tribal communities.

The same spirit of inclusion is shaping how artificial intelligence is being integrated into tribal development. At the India AI Impact Summit 2026, the Ministry presented a range of AI-enabled platforms built on a simple but powerful

belief: that language is not a barrier to be overcome but an identity to be celebrated. Adi Vaani, an AI-powered Translator for Tribal Languages, supports text-to-text and text-to-speech translation, OCR, and delivery of government scheme information in tribal languages, enabling citizens to engage with public services in the language they speak at home. TriBoT, a multilingual conversational AI assistant, further strengthens this effort by providing real-time guidance and grievance support to citizens in remote regions. These efforts were also discussed during a national seminar organised with the Bhagwan Birsa Munda Cell and IIT Delhi, which focused on culturally sensitive and community-centric applications of AI, including long-term preservation and strengthening of tribal languages.

Technology is also becoming a powerful instrument of cultural assertion and economic empowerment. The forthcoming TribeX platform aims to create a digital ecosystem for promoting tribal arts, languages, traditional knowledge, music, crafts, and cultural experiences. Complementing this effort, the proposed GI Potential Art and Craft Atlas of Tribal India will digitally map tribal handicrafts, forest products, and traditional art forms with Geographical Indication potential, helping strengthen branding, market access, and recognition of tribal intellectual heritage.

Innovation Hubs, planned across Tribal Research Institutes in five states

on a pilot basis, will go further still, combining design and product development support, GIS-based planning dashboards, and incubation infrastructure for innovation-led tribal entrepreneurs and startups.

Technology is equally transforming the way governance reaches tribal communities. Survey Setu, deployed under PM-JANMAN for PVTG household surveys, enables real-time, geo-tagged monitoring of welfare delivery across remote regions. Operating across 18 States and 1 Union Territory, the platform has already recorded 3.43 lakh household submissions with the support of 8,552 surveyors. Such data-driven systems help ensure that every eligible family is identified and connected to essential services. In parallel, the Ministry is developing an AI-enabled Forest Rights Act governance platform to streamline claim submissions, GIS-based mapping, workflow monitoring, and grievance redressal. Together, these initiatives are making governance more transparent, responsive, and accessible for tribal citizens.

Tribal Communities: Drivers of Viksit Bharat

There is a moment that captures the essence of everything we are working towards. It is not found in a policy document or a ministerial review. It is found when a tribal woman in a remote habitation, empowered by technology, by language, and by the assurance that the state is listening, engages with government services on her own terms and receives an answer with full dignity. That moment is not the end of a journey. It is the beginning of a new chapter in India’s national story.

Janjatiya Garima Utsav carries this message with pride. Tribal communities, with their resilience, their ecological wisdom, their artistic traditions, and their deep roots in this land, are not waiting at the threshold of Viksit Bharat. They are among its most powerful and inspiring drivers. As technology bridges distances, as science delivers healing, as AI speaks in the languages of the forests and the hills, and as governance reaches the last family in the remotest village, we move closer each day to India that is not merely developed in measure, but complete in its humanity. That is the Viksit Bharat we are building together, inspired by the vision of the Hon’ble Prime Minister.

Views expressed are personal

BHARAT
KI SOCH



ANIL RAJPUT
THE WRITER IS
CHAIRPERSON
BHARAT KI SOCH

The first major principle that emerges from the life of Maharishi Ved Vyas is the responsibility of organising knowledge for the benefit of society

Timeless Lessons of Ved Vyas

From preserving the Veds to composing the Mahabharata, Maharishi Ved Vyas demonstrated how wisdom, discipline and ethics sustain societies across generations

In an age marked by information overload, professional competition, ethical uncertainty and social fragmentation, the life and legacy of Maharishi Ved Vyas continue to offer remarkable relevance to modern corporate and social life. Revered not only as a sage and philosopher, but also as a master organiser of knowledge, interpreter of human nature and guide to ethical living, Vyas represents the continuing importance of purposeful intent, diligent understanding and moral balance in the conduct of both institutions and individuals. His insights into leadership, duty, relationships, conflict and self-discipline remain strikingly relevant in a world that increasingly seeks success, without losing sight of righteousness, integrity and social harmony.

Maharishi Ved Vyas is believed to have lived during a formative period of ancient Indian civilisation, at a time when spiritual knowledge, social order and political life were undergoing significant transition. Born to the sage Parashara and Satyawati on an island in the Yamuna, he came to be known as Krishna Dvaipayana, “the dark one born on an island.” Raised within the disciplined tradition of Vedic learning and tapasya, Vyas emerged as one of the greatest intellectual and spiritual figures in Indian civilisation. He is traditionally credited with compiling and classifying the Veds into four parts for easier preservation and transmission, composing the epic Mahabharata, authoring the Brahma Sutras and shaping much of the Puranic tradition. More than a literary figure, Vyas served as a bridge between knowledge and society, ensuring that spiritual wisdom remained accessible, organised and relevant to changing times.

The first major principle that emerges from the life of Maharishi Ved Vyas is the responsibility of organising knowledge for the benefit of society. Tradition credits him with arranging the vast body of Vedic wisdom into the RigVed, YajurVed, SamaVed and AtharvaVed. This was not merely an intellectual accomplishment, but an act of far-reaching social vision. Vyas recognised that even the highest knowledge can weaken over time if it is not preserved with clarity and structure. He understood that knowledge must be codified before it can create lasting value, and that wisdom should not remain dependent upon the memory or ability of a few exceptional individuals. It must be organised in ways that allow continuity across generations. The lesson remains deeply relevant in the modern world, where institutions, universities, archives, corporations and public platforms carry the responsibility of preserving, managing and transmitting knowledge without distortion or fragmentation.



Vyas was a visionary organiser of knowledge whose ideas on ethics, leadership and continuity remain deeply relevant today

Another enduring principle from the life of Maharishi Ved Vyas emerges through his composition of the Mahabharata, one of the most profound explorations of human nature, power, morality and social responsibility ever written. Rather than presenting life in simplistic terms of heroes and villains, Vyas portrayed individuals with complexity, strengths, weaknesses, ambitions and moral dilemmas. Kings, teachers, warriors and families are shown struggling between personal desire, duty, loyalty, ego and justice. One of his greatest contributions was the ability to translate complex ideas into narratives that ordinary people could understand without diminishing their moral depth. This remains an enduring lesson for leadership. The best leaders convert complex strategy into clear narratives that inspire people, align action and help institutions understand why certain choices matter. His work also reminds us that the creation of great knowledge requires more than inspiration. It requires understanding, patience and discipline, because speed without comprehension can weaken the very wisdom it seeks to preserve.

The Mahabharata also reflects a deep understanding that human decisions are rarely shaped by simple choices, but by considered decisions, emotional discipline and ethical judgement when confronted with complexities. In contemporary cor-

porate and social life, this offers important lessons. Effective leadership requires the ability to understand competing interests, manage conflict without losing fairness and recognise that decisions taken without moral reflection can eventually damage both institutions and relationships. Vyas's work reminds modern society that intelligence without ethics, ambition without restraint and authority without wisdom often become the source of instability and decline. It also teaches that uncomfortable truths must be spoken before a crisis becomes irreversible, even when such counsel is ignored. Effective leaders identify risks early and address critical issues openly rather than avoiding uncomfortable conversations.

The life of Maharishi Ved Vyas also highlights the importance of tapasya, disciplined austerity, self-restraint and inner refinement when pursued for higher understanding and responsibility. Vyas did not undertake tapasya as an escape from society, but as a means to deepen clarity of thought, strengthen self-mastery and cultivate the wisdom necessary to guide others. In the Indian tradition, tapasya was not merely physical hardship but represented the training of the mind and character. Modern institutions often reward speed, visibility and constant activity, yet enduring leadership frequently depends upon emotional control, restraint

in speech, the ability to withstand pressure and the capacity to act without being driven by ego or impulse. Vyas's example suggests that those who wish to guide organisations, communities, or families responsibly must first cultivate mastery over themselves, for authority without inner discipline can easily become reactive, unstable or self-serving.

Another significant dimension of the life of Maharishi Ved Vyas was his role as a teacher and transmitter of knowledge. His contribution did not end with composing or organising knowledge. He ensured that it was passed forward through disciples and disciplined traditions of learning. Vyas is associated with guiding and teaching sages such as Vaishampayana, Jaimini and others who carried different branches of knowledge into wider society. This reflects the important principle that knowledge achieves its highest value only when it develops capable successors and strengthens institutions beyond the individual. In contemporary corporate, educational and social life, this carries a powerful lesson about mentorship and continuity. Many organisations struggle not because of a lack of talent, but because experience is not transferred, younger generations are not prepared for responsibility and leadership becomes concentrated in a few individuals. Vyas's example teaches that true leadership creates leaders, not followers,

and that influence can outlast authority when it is rooted in trust and service.

For modern India, Maharishi Ved Vyas offers an example of lasting relevance because it resonates with our current needs. He reminds us that knowledge must be acquired with patience, preserved with discipline and taught with integrity. Contemporary society may possess an abundance of facts and information, but knowledge becomes truly meaningful only when it is connected with historical memory, moral judgment, and a sense of continuity over time. His life shows that inherited wisdom should not be treated as a burden from the past, but as a foundation that must be understood, interpreted and applied responsibly to the needs of the present. Institutions must build memory before a crisis exposes the cost of forgetting. Civilisations survive not only through memory, but through institutions of memory that preserve, interpret and transmit knowledge across generations.

His example is also deeply relevant to nation-building. A nation does not draw strength merely from economic growth, infrastructure, technology or military capability, important as each of these is. It also draws strength from cultural confidence, ethical education, institutional memory and the ability to connect progress with values. India's progress must protect its ethical foundation alongside economic growth, technological advancement and institutional expansion. Sustainable organisations and societies must balance immediate performance with long-term institution-building. Vyas's legacy reminds us to think not only in quarters but in centuries. If a society forgets its past, it weakens the moral fabric through which it understands duty, justice, and responsibility. If it neglects its teachers, it weakens the channels through which experience and information move from one generation to another and strengthens society.

Therein lies the greatness of Maharishi Ved. His story, therefore, should not be seen only as the story of a sage associated with ancient texts but as a study of how knowledge becomes service when it is used for the moral strengthening of society. He did not build an empire of power, but a civilisational institution of knowledge whose relevance continues even for the modern world. True leadership is not only about achieving immediate results, but about organising wisdom, nurturing people and creating a legacy that benefits generations to come. To remember him is to recognise that a society honours its past not by repeating it without direction, but by understanding it deeply and carrying its values into the future with responsibility and confidence.

Views expressed are personal

RETHINKING
TRANSIT



SHALABH GOEL
THE WRITER IS
THE MANAGING
DIRECTOR, NCRTC

Initiatives such as 'Namo Bharat Unplugged: Musical Fridays' and 'Namo Bharat Beats' are reimagining stations as cultural canvases while providing platforms to emerging artists

Beyond Mobility, Towards Community

As cities lose shared public spaces, transit infrastructure is increasingly becoming a new centre for urban social interaction and belonging

As more and more people flock to cities in search of better opportunities, urban landscapes expand to accommodate them, growing taller, denser, and faster than ever before. However, in this race, something quieter is shrinking, our shared spaces. The neighbourhood park where conversations once flowed across generations is increasingly replaced by concrete. Sidewalks that doubled as informal playgrounds for children or neighbourhood meeting points are swallowed by ever-widening roads. Social interaction, once woven naturally into daily life, now often requires entering a commercial space, and those spaces come with an entry cost, monetary or social. The question for modern cities, then, is not just how to move people efficiently, but where people can simply connect with one another comfortably.

Public transport stations are beginning to answer that question in unexpected ways. Traditionally seen as purely functional nodes, points of arrival and departure, they are now evolving into places of pause, interaction, and shared urban life. A station today is not merely a transit facility; it is often where a student waits for a friend, a professional catches a quiet coffee between meetings, a family begins a day out, or sometimes people simply escape the weather while waiting for a train. When thoughtfully designed, stations offer openness and accessibility, qualities that many cities are gradually losing elsewhere.

Globally, urban transit systems have long demonstrated how well-designed stations can become vibrant urban anchors rather than anonymous transit points. Cities like London and Seoul offer several examples where stations function as important urban spaces. Major stations in Japan, such as Yokohama, Nagoya and Fukuoka, illustrate this beautifully. From enjoying a bowl of tonkotsu ramen to browsing manga or watching live performances, these spaces bring together culture, convenience and community, transforming stations into vibrant social hubs rather than mere transit points.



Thoughtfully designed transit stations can restore comfort, connection, visibility and community in cities

Safety, in fact, is central to this transformation. A well-lit, monitored, and professionally managed station provides a level of comfort that few public spaces can guarantee today. For many women, elderly citizens, and young commuters, such environments offer a rare sense of security in the public realm. This psychological safety is just as critical as physical security in shaping inclusive urban spaces.

Food kiosks, retail options, clean seating areas, intuitive wayfinding, and barrier-free design further humanise these environments. They turn waiting time into usable time. Instead of being “dead time,” a commute can accommodate a quick errand, a casual conversation, or a moment of rest. In dense urban lives, such micro-opportunities for pause are deeply valuable.

In India, too, this shift is becoming increasingly visible as modern transit networks expand. There is growing recognition that transit infrastructure inter-

acts with daily life far beyond mobility; it influences how cities come together and socialise. As transit networks expand and modernise, expectations from stations are evolving. They are increasingly being designed not only for efficiency but also for experience.

At Akshardham Delhi Metro station, for instance, the Aadhaar Kendra on the lower ground floor facilitates thousands of citizens. The Greater Hyderabad Municipal Corporation (GHMC) has developed sports arenas, including badminton and basketball courts, beneath flyovers, creatively transforming unused spaces into community fitness zones. Similarly, the Epicuria mall at the concourse level of Nehru Place Metro station has redefined the locality and become a popular social hub.

Within this broader movement, the Namo Bharat corridor offers an emerg-

ing example of how transit spaces can be planned with people at the centre. NCRTC has been making continuous efforts to transform stations into welcoming social spaces. Cultural initiatives such as “Namo Bharat Unplugged: Musical Fridays” and “Namo Bharat Beats” are steadily reimagining stations as cultural canvases while providing platforms to emerging artists. A photo exhibition titled “Sitaare Namo Bharat Mein,” curated by neurodiverse artists, offered thousands of passengers the opportunity to see the world through a different lens. Art exhibitions, live sketching corners, book fairs, and thematic showcases on environment and nation-building have further enriched these spaces. Celebrations of social, cultural and national occasions like Republic Day, Independence Day, International Women's Day, World Health Day, Christmas and so on are celebrated at the stations and with the commut-

ers. The intent is not to create destinations in themselves, but to ensure that the commuter experience remains humane and connected to community life.

Commuter amenities such as food outlets, lockers, mobile charging stations and electric vehicle charging facilities are being introduced across stations. At the Ghaziabad Namo Bharat station, a co-working space has been opened at the concourse level, offering a flexible, future-ready workspace for professionals, entrepreneurs and small businesses.

The effort has been to create stations that are airy, well-lit, accessible, and most importantly, integrated with other public transport systems wherever possible. The corridor connects the national capital, Delhi, with the historic city of Meerut while passing through Ghaziabad, Modinagar, Rithani, Begumpul and several other towns. The walls of stations, adorned with murals, showcase the social, cultural and archaeological heritage of these cities. From depictions of the First War of Independence to the famed sports industry of Meerut, the GI-tagged bugle and the city's musical traditions, these murals transform transit spaces into visual narratives rooted in local history and pride.

The common thread is simple: when a space is safe, welcoming and accessible, people naturally make it their own. For urban planners and mobility leaders, this presents an important opportunity to design transit infrastructure that serves both movement and community life. Ultimately, the future of urban mobility is not only about speed or technology; it is also about how infrastructure shapes human interaction.

As cities continue to densify, truly public spaces will become even more precious. If planned with sensitivity, transit stations can quietly restore something cities are losing, the ability for strangers to share space comfortably, for communities to feel visible, and for daily journeys to carry a sense of ease. In doing so, stations move beyond being points on a map and become meaningful parts of urban social life.

Views expressed are personal

RIISING DOG MENACE

SC allows euthanasia for rabid & incurably ill stray dogs

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court for the first time on Tuesday allowed euthanasia for rabid, incurably ill, or demonstrably dangerous stray dogs to curb the threat to human life

A bench of Justices Vikram Nath, Sandeep Mehta and NV Anjaria issued a slew of directions to deal with the rising population of stray dogs in the country.

The bench emphatically stated that ordering the euthanasia of stray dogs is the most important direction it is issuing to authorities and officials of civic bodies.

It said the civic authorities may resort to euthanasia in areas where the stray dog population has reached alarming proportions and where frequent dog bites or aggressive attacks pose a continuing threat to public safety.

The action, as well as other legal measures, may be taken after an assessment by veterinary experts and in strict accordance with the provisions of the Prevention of Cruelty to Animals Act 1960, the Animal Birth Control Rules 2023 and other applicable statutory protocols, the bench said.

The top court passed the order in a suo motu case, initiated on July 28 last year, over a media report on stray dog bites leading to rabies, particularly among children, in the national capital.

On Tuesday, it dismissed pleas seeking a recall of its earlier order on the relocation and sterilisation of stray



Highlights

- » A bench issued a slew of directions to deal with the rising population of stray dogs in the country
- » It also directed the states and UTs to take steps to enhance the Animal Birth Control framework
- » On Tuesday, top court dismissed pleas seeking a recall of its earlier order on the relocation and sterilisation of stray canines

canines, as it observed that the right to live with dignity encompasses the right to move freely without the threat of harm from dog bite attacks.

It directed the states and Union Territories to ensure the implementation of its earlier direction not to return dogs picked up from public places to the same spot after vaccination/sterilisation.

It also directed the states and UTs to take steps to enhance the Animal Birth Control framework.

“Ensure establishment of at least one fully functional ABC centre in each district duly equipped with requisite

infrastructure and trained personnel, surgical facilities and supporting logistics,” the bench said.

“The court cannot remain oblivious to harsh ground realities where children, international travellers and old age people have fallen victim to dog bite incidents,” it added.

On November 7 last year, the court took note of the “alarming rise” in dog-bite incidents in areas such as educational institutions, hospitals and railway stations and directed that stray dogs be relocated to designated shelters after sterilisation and vaccination.

Focus must shift towards rapid development of regions affected by Naxal violence: Shah

States improvements in Central Zonal Council's outcomes during PM Modi's tenure

NARESH BISWANI

BASTAR: Union Home minister Amit Shah on Tuesday chaired the 26th meeting of the Central Zonal Council (CZC) in Bastar, Chhattisgarh, and said the focus now must shift towards rapid development of regions affected by decades of Naxal violence.

Present at the gathering were senior officials from both central and state governments alongside leaders representing several regions. Leading figures included Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai of Chhattisgarh, followed by Mohan Yadav who serves Madhya Pradesh.

In attendance also stood Yogi Adityanath, representing Uttar Pradesh, while Pushkar Singh Dhami appeared on behalf of Uttarakhand. Participation extended beyond individual names, incorporating administrative representatives whose



roles support governance across involved territories.

With calm words at the start, Shah called the Bastar event a turning point. Years of unrest gave way after joint operations unfolded across forces. Intelligence networks worked alongside central troops. State-level officers moved in parallel. Progress came slowly, yet clearly visible now.

“The fight against Naxalism was not only about eliminating extremists, but also about ensuring development reaches every

village,” Shah said.

Although security actions reduced Naxal influence, focus now shifts to closing developmental shortfalls across impacted zones.

Collaboration between federal and regional authorities becomes essential when advancing schooling, medical services, food support systems, financial inclusion, clean water availability, along with village-level facilities.

The Home minister stated improvements in the Central

Zonal Council's outcomes during Prime Minister Narendra Modi's tenure.

During 2014 to 2026, thirty-two meetings took place, whereas eleven occurred from 2004 to 2014.

Progress appears linked to increased frequency of discussions. Earlier years saw fewer gatherings. Under current oversight, activity levels rose sharply. Meetings now happen at a faster pace than before.

Moreover, Shah encouraged states to enhance execution of the Jal Jeevan Mission, while advancing access to financial services alongside lowering student attrition.

Regarding public safety, quicker DNA analysis in POCSO and rape matters was emphasized by him, aiming at higher conviction outcomes, along with a push for swifter resolution of criminal proceedings.

FOLLOWING TECHNICAL ISSUE

DGCA directs additional checks on Air India 787 FCS

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) has directed further inspection of the Fuel Control Switches (FCS) of an Air India Boeing 787-8 aircraft after pilots reported a technical issue involving the left engine fuel control switch during post-flight checks earlier this year.

So far, only that single aircraft has been flagged under the new scrutiny. Technical faults like these rarely surface mid-flight, but ground findings sometimes trigger follow-up steps. This case unfolded after landing procedures were completed.

Officials confirmed their

involvement following internal reports from flight crews.

On February 2, 2026, aviation regulators halted operations of Air India's VT-ANX plane post its arrival from London Heathrow to Bengaluru on flight AI-132. This followed a pilot log noting the left Fuel Control Switch shifted unexpectedly - from “RUN” to “CUTOFF” - with minor pressure, failing to stay securely set.

After the report came out, inspections began at Air India under OEM guidelines. Function checks on Fuel Control Switches followed shortly after. Officials from DGCA watched each step unfold. Procedures matched those specified by the equipment maker.

OVER THE LAST NINE YEARS

UP Police neutralised 289 criminals in encounters, arrested over 34,000

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: Under the Yogi Adityanath government's zero-tolerance policy against crime, Uttar Pradesh Police has neutralised 289 dreaded criminals in encounters over the last nine years while carrying out more than 17,000 encounter operations across the state.

According to official figures released by the state government, police conducted 17,043 encounters during the period in which 34,253 criminals were arrested and 11,834 injured. Eighteen policemen lost their lives in the line of duty while 1,852 police personnel sustained injuries during these operations.

Meerut Zone recorded the highest number of encounter operations in the state. Police carried out 4,813 encounters in the zone, arresting 8,921 criminals and injuring 3,513 accused. A total of 97 criminals were killed in police action in the zone. During these operations, 477 policemen were injured and two personnel were killed while on duty.

Varanasi Zone ranked second in the state with 1,292 encounter operations. Police arrested 2,426 criminals and neutralised 29 accused during the period. As many as 907 criminals and 104 policemen were injured in the operations.

Agra Zone stood third with 2,494 encounter operations in

which 5,845 criminals were arrested. Police said 968 criminals were injured and 24 were killed in encounters, while 62 policemen sustained injuries.

In Bareilly Zone, 21 criminals were killed during 2,222 encounters, while Lucknow Zone reported 20 criminals killed in 971 encounters. Ghaziabad Commissionerate recorded the highest number of criminals killed among commissionerates with 18 accused neutralised in 789 encounters.

Kanpur Zone reported 12 criminals killed in 791 encounters, while Lucknow Commissionerate recorded 12 accused killed in 147 encounters. Prayagraj Zone reported 11 criminals killed in 643 encounters.

‘Op Sindoor reflected ‘smart power’ in its most complete expression’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Under Operation Sindoor, Indian forces dismantled terror infrastructure, punctured a long-standing strategic assumption, and then stopped “deliberately and purposefully,” and it reflected “smart power” in its most complete expression, Army Chief Gen Upendra Dwivedi said on Tuesday.

In his address at a seminar hosted at the Manekshaw Centre here, he also said that twelve months ago, India offered the world a “partial answer” to the so-called smart power question.

“On the intervening night of May 6-7 in 2025, Bharat acted. In a precisely defined 22-minute operation window, Operation Sindoor delivered military precision, information control, diplomatic signalling and economic resolve, as one coherent national act. We struck deep, dismantled terror infrastructure, punctured a long-standing strategic assumption, and then stopped, deliberately and purposefully,” the Army chief said.

“The deliberate thought after 88 hours, was smart power in its most complete expression, knowing exactly which instrument to apply, at what intensity, and precisely when to convert a military moment into a strategic one,” he asserted.

The seminar, titled, “Security to Prosperity: Smart Power for Sustained National Growth,” hosted by defence think-tank Centre for Land Warfare Studies (CLAWS), was attended by senior military officials, various retired Army officers and representatives from several countries. Gen Dwivedi said today, the “world around us is sending a more complex signal -- disorder, distrust, and dichotomy in alliances.”

“We were promised a world where prosperity would make power politics obsolete... instead, we have a world where power politics is being used to reorganise prosperity,” he argued.

Resolve complaints received on CM Window on a priority basis: Saini

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini said that resolving people's grievances is the state government's top priority. He directed officials not to show any negligence in addressing public complaints.

The Chief Minister was reviewing complaints received on the CM Window portal during a meeting with administrative officials. Deputy Commissioners, Superintendents of Police, and Divisional Commissioners from all districts also joined the meeting through videoconferencing.

Reviewing complaints related to various departments at the district level, the Chief Minister directed officials to ensure their prompt resolution. He also



instructed that nodal officers be appointed at every district level for CM Window issues.

The Chief Minister sought detailed information from all Deputy Commissioners regarding complaints received through the CM Window and issued necessary directions. He said that along with resolved complaints, unresolved issues should also be reviewed carefully.

Meanwhile, chairing a review meeting regarding the ‘mhari

Sadak App’, CM Saini has directed that in all districts of the state, at least one major complaint received on the “Mhari Sadak App” must be mandatorily reviewed in public grievance meetings and in monthly review meetings chaired by Deputy Commissioners.

The objective is to enhance the usefulness of the App and ensure strict action against officers showing negligence in grievance redressal.

‘Centre, state govt taking CDV spread at Kanha Tiger Reserve seriously’

In April this year, a tigress and her four cubs lost their lives at the reserve after suffering lung infection caused by the CDV

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The spread of the canine distemper virus (CDV) among tigers in Madhya Pradesh's Kanha Tiger Reserve has been taken seriously by the Central and state governments, Union Environment minister Bhupendra Yadav said on Tuesday.

In an interview with news agency, Yadav said that after the last month's incident, the state forest department intensified patrolling, surveillance and camera trap monitoring besides due scanning and sanitation of the affected area.

On Tuesday, another tiger is suspected to have died due to the virus, commonly found in dogs, at the reserve, taking the total number of such fatalities to six.

In April, a tigress and four cubs lost their lives at the reserve after suffering lung infection caused by the



CDV.

“Vaccination of stray and domestic dogs has also been initiated to prevent further spread of the disease,” the environment minister said.

National Tiger Conservation Authority (NTCA) officials have also visited the site and the state has been advised to maintain strict vigilance and strengthen disease

surveillance.

On May 5, the NTCA issued an advisory to all tiger-bearing states to remain alert and take preventive and proactive measures with respect to the canine distemper virus, according to Yadav. “Animal Welfare Board of India has also been taken into loop to effectively address the issues especially

Key Points

- » Vaccination of stray and domestic dogs has also been initiated to prevent further spread of the disease, the environment minister said
- » On Tuesday, another tiger is suspected to have died due to the virus, commonly found in dogs, at the reserve, taking the total number of such fatalities to six
- » NTCA officials have also visited the site and the state has been advised to maintain strict vigilance and strengthen disease surveillance

with respect to the straying of domestic dogs in the vicinity of tiger reserves,” said the minister.

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Closer Look

» Questioning the Centre's repeated appeals for austerity, CM Mann said no other country affected by global crisis has asked its citizens

to stop buying petrol, diesel, gas or gold

» Mann said the same leadership that once claimed India would become a ‘Vishav Guru’ has reduced the country to a ‘Vishav Chela’

instead of spreading panic and inconvenience.

Targeting Prime Minister Narendra Modi over his foreign policy, CM Mann said the same leadership that once claimed India would become a “Vishav Guru” has reduced the country to a “Vishav Chela,” while pointing out that the Prime Minister's foreign visits have yielded little for ordinary Indians except benefits for a handful of favoured indus-

trialists who accompany him abroad for business deals.

Interacting with media persons on the sidelines of launching an ambitious project to put high-tension wires underground, CM Bhagwant Singh Mann said the Modi government has completely failed on both foreign and economic policy fronts, due to which the country is in disarray.

“The Modi government has completely failed on For-

eign and economic policy due to which the country is in disarray. The Union government failed to anticipate the gravity of the situation arising out of the Gulf war, leading to complete chaos in the country.”

The Chief Minister pointed out, “It is ironic that the war has taken place between Israel and Iran but only India is suffering whereas the situation is not so grim in any other neighbouring country.”

Meanwhile, Chief Minister Mann on Tuesday launched a first-of-its-kind initiative to transform Punjab into the country's first state with pole-free villages by laying the foundation stone of an ambitious underground electricity wiring project in his native village Satauj.

Nation Briefs

CBI ARRESTS ARMY COLONEL IN RS 50 LAKH ‘BRIBERY’ CASE

NEW DELHI: The CBI has arrested a colonel posted with the Army Ordnance Corps under the Eastern Command in Kolkata in connection with an alleged Rs 50 lakh bribery case, officials said on Tuesday. The officer is accused of favouring a Kanpur-based company by allegedly manipulating the award of tenders, approving standard samples, and facilitating clearance of pending and inflated bills. In its FIR, the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) said the colonel had contacted the industrialist over the pending bribe payment, to which the businessman cited cash constraints. The agency alleged that the officer later called the industrialist's driver and asked him to deliver the payment to one of his acquaintances. The pending bribe amount of Rs 50 lakh was to be routed through hawala channels, it alleged.

MP: FOUR-YEAR-OLD DIES AFTER GETTING TRAPPED INSIDE CAR IN INDORE

INDORE: A four-year-old girl died of suspected suffocation after getting trapped inside a car amid scorching heat in Madhya Pradesh's Indore city, police said on Tuesday. The incident took place on Monday under the Juni Indore police station limits, and the deceased was identified as Hazra, an official said. According to preliminary investigation, the girl got trapped inside the car on Sunday, and remained in the vehicle for several hours. The official said family members later found the child unconscious inside the car and rushed her to a hospital, where doctors declared her dead.

TRUMP REPEATEDLY SET DEADLINES FOR TEHRAN AND THEN BACKED OFF

Trump’s tough-talk foreign policy hitting wall with Iran

WASHINGTON: US President Donald Trump has considered himself an effective dealmaker above all else, but he appears to have hit a wall with Iran as his tough talk, threats and even military action have not moved Tehran from its long-established positions.

With shifting goals that make it difficult to judge the status of the US effort, Trump and his top aides have insisted the United States has already won the war and that Iran is ready to reach an agreement in the wake of escalating US threats during a tenuous ceasefire.

But Trump once again backed down, saying Monday that he had put plans for an imminent resumption of attacks on hold at the request of Gulf Arab states because “serious negotiations are now taking place, and that, in their opinion, as Great Leaders and Allies, a Deal will be made, which will be very acceptable to the United States of America, as well as all Countries in the Middle East, and beyond”.

Although he said he had called off strikes planned for Tuesday, Trump kept up the bravado, saying he told



People hold roses as they attend a mass wedding ceremony for couples participating in the 'Janfada' (Sacrifice for Iran) pro-government campaign in Tehran

Highlights

- » Trump once again backed down, saying Monday that he had put plans for an imminent resumption of attacks on hold at the request of Gulf Arab
- » Crucially, Iran still has a chokehold on the Strait of Hormuz, vital shipping lane for global oil supplies

military leaders “to be prepared to go forward with a full, large scale assault of Iran, on a moment’s notice, in the event that an acceptable deal

is not reached”. Trump has repeatedly set deadlines for Tehran and then backed off. Despite growing internal unrest, a crippled economy

and the deaths of many of its leaders, there is no evidence Iran is set to meet Trump’s demands — many of which it has long rejected. In fact, it has dug in. That has left Trump’s stated top objectives unrealised: Iran has yet to agree to abandon its nuclear programme or its ballistic missile development, or cease support for its proxies in the region, including those in Gaza, Iraq, Lebanon

and Yemen.

The White House on Monday defended the president’s approach, saying, “Trump’s preference is always peace and diplomacy” but he will only accept a deal that puts America first.

“President Trump holds all the cards and wisely keeps all options on the table to ensure that Iran can never have a nuclear weapon,” spokesperson Olivia Wales said in a statement to The Associated Press.

Crucially, Iran still has a chokehold on the Strait of Hormuz, the vital shipping lane for global oil supplies, even as the US military has enforced its own blockade on Iranian ports.

The wild shifts in the global energy market that followed have raised gasoline prices, hurting US consumers and causing potential problems for Trump’s Republican Party ahead of congressional midterm elections in November. Trump’s playbook of turning up the pressure — economically and militarily — to bend foreign governments to his will is not playing out in Iran as it has in Venezuela, Cuba and elsewhere.

Russia holds massive drills of nuclear forces as Ukraine steps up drone attacks

MOSCOW: Russia on Tuesday began massive maneuvers of its nuclear forces featuring practice launches of nuclear-capable ballistic and cruise missiles in drills that come amid surge in Ukrainian drone strikes. The three-day exercise will involve 64,000 troops, over 200 missile launchers, more than 140 aircraft, 73 surface warships and 13 submarines, including eight armed with nuclear-tipped intercontinental ballistic missiles, the Defence Ministry said.

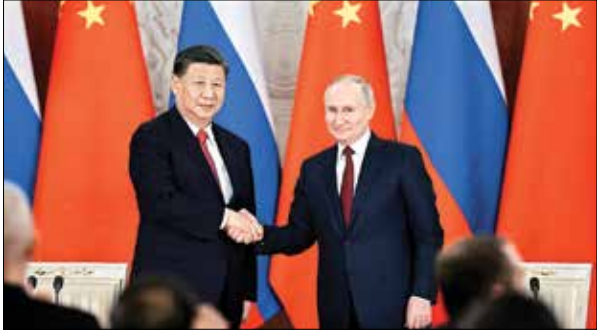
The maneuvers will focus on the “preparation and use of nuclear forces under the threat of aggression,” the ministry said.

The drills will also practice cooperation with Belarus, a neighbour and ally that hosts Russian nuclear weapons. Russian arsenals in Belarus include its latest intermediate range nuclear-capable Oreshnik missile system. The maneuvers come as Ukraine has sharply intensified its drone attacks against Russia, including a weekend barrage on Moscow’s suburbs that killed three and damaged several buildings and industrial facilities. Russian President Vladimir Putin has repeatedly reminded the world about Moscow’s nuclear arsenals after sending troops into Ukraine in February 2022 to try to deter the West from ramping up support for Kyiv.

The recent attacks have made it harder for officials in the Kremlin to cast the conflict in Ukraine — now in its fifth year — as something so distant that it doesn’t affect the daily routines of Russian civilians.

Putin visits China to reaffirm Russia ties

As Xi also seeks stable US relations



Russian President Vladimir Putin with Chinese President Xi Jinping

BEIJING: Russian President Vladimir Putin arrived in Beijing on Tuesday night on a two-day state visit for talks with his Chinese counterpart Xi Jinping, days after US leader Donald Trump travelled to China.

Xi and Putin will exchange views on bilateral ties, cooperation in various fields, as well as international and regional issues of mutual interest, the Chinese Foreign Ministry said.

This is Putin’s 25th visit to China, foreign ministry spokesperson Guo Jiakun told a media briefing here on Monday, emphasising close strategic ties between Russia and China as well as strong friendship and rapport between the two leaders.

“The two sides will take this visit as an opportunity to continue to promote the development of China-Russia relations to a higher level, which

will inject greater stability and positive energy into the world,” Guo said.

Since Xi took power in 2012, the two leaders have met dozens of times, frequently referring to each other as “dear friend” and emphasising mutual trust.

Their ties have strengthened through cooperation in trade, energy, security, and efforts to counter Western influence and observers view the Xi-Putin relationship as one of the most significant political partnerships in contemporary global affairs.

Significantly, Putin is visiting Beijing days after Trump’s three-day trip here from May 14 to 16, during which he held close-door talks with Xi on a host of global and bilateral issues.

They were expected to exchange views on Trump’s visit to Beijing.

Congo reports sharp rise in Ebola cases

Health ministry reports 131 deaths, 513 suspected cases

KINSHASA: The World Health Organisation director-general openly worried Tuesday over the “scale and speed” of an outbreak of a rare Ebola variant in eastern Congo, where authorities reported a sharp increase in suspected deaths — to at least 131 — and over 500 suspected cases.

The virus spread undetected for weeks after the first known death as authorities tested for a more common strain and came up negative, health experts and aid workers said. This Bundibugyo virus, a rare variant, has no approved medicines or vaccines. Congo’s health minister, Samuel Roger Kamba, said investigations were underway to determine whether the deaths and 513 suspected cases were “actually linked to the disease.”

WHO director-general Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus said he is “deeply concerned about the scale and speed of the epidemic,” adding the UN health agency will convene its emergency committee later Tuesday. He pointed to the emergence of cases in urban areas, the deaths of healthcare workers and significant population movement.

The WHO has declared the Ebola outbreak a public health emergency of international concern, requiring a coordinated response. Resources were being rushed to the two affected provinces near the border with Uganda, which has reported one death in a person who travelled from Congo.

The head of the WHO

team in Congo said authorities haven’t identified “patient zero” in the outbreak.

Dr Anne Ancia also said the Erbevo vaccine, used against a different Ebola strain, was among those being considered for possible use. But even if that or another is approved, it would take two months to become available.

Inside Congo, cases have been confirmed in the capital of Ituri province, Bunia; North Kivu’s rebel-held capital, Goma; and the localities of Mongwalu, Nyakunde and Butembo — home to well over a million people in all. Dr Peter Stafford, an American doctor, is among the Bunia cases, said the Christian organisation he works for, Serge. He had been treating patients at a hospital.

Board of Peace will ask UNSC to press Hamas to disarm

GENEVA: The body overseeing the US-brokered ceasefire in Gaza will ask the United Nations Security Council to press the Hamas militant group to disarm, according to a report seen by The Associated Press on Tuesday.

The report by the Board of Peace is expected to be discussed by the Security Council on Thursday when it meets on the situation in the Middle East. “At this stage, the principal obstacle to full implementation (of the ceasefire) remains Hamas’ refusal to accept verified decommissioning, relinquish coercive control, and permit a genuine civilian transition in Gaza,” the report said.

MANY SHIPS WERE STILL WITHIN 100 NAUTICAL MILES OF GAZA Israeli forces intercept another boat with activists seeking to challenge Gaza blockage

JERUSALEM: Israeli forces intercepted one of the remaining Gaza flotilla boats, stopping the vessel when it was about 82 nautical miles (around 150 kilometres or 95 miles) from Gaza, according to the flotilla’s website tracker.

A livestream on the website showed Israeli forces in a dinghy pulling up to the boat, called the “Andros,” and activists with their arms in the air.

The screen then went dark with a message saying the boat had been intercepted.

A handful of ships were still within 100 nautical miles of Gaza and sailing toward it as of Tuesday afternoon.

The Israeli navy’s new action resumed a day after the Israeli navy interdicted the



Protesters chant pro-Palestinian slogans outside Greece’s Foreign Ministry after Israel’s navy intercepted an activist flotilla in waters off of Cyprus on Tuesday

activist flotilla in international waters off Cyprus.

It was the latest attempt by

the Global Sumud Flotilla to challenge Israel’s naval blockade of Gaza and underscore the

Some 41 boats were intercepted on Monday, with another 10 continuing to sail before the Andros interception, as per Global Sumud Flotilla’s tracker

grim living conditions of Palestinians living in the territory.

Dozens of vessels departed from the port of Marmaris, Turkey, last week in what flotilla organisers described as the final leg of their planned journey to Gaza’s shores.

Trump admin plans to admit more white South Africans as refugees



US President Donald Trump

WASHINGTON: The Trump administration plans to admit up to 10,000 more white South African refugees into the United States in the coming months, arguing that their status as Afrikaners has left them open to discrimination and persecution at home.

The South African government has said the Trump administration’s claims are baseless.

But President Donald Trump has insisted the white Afrikaner minority has faced systematic discrimination and violence, particularly attacks against its farming communities — prompting him to cut off aid to South Africa, engage in a fiery Oval Office confrontation with its president and boycott last year’s Group of 20 summit in Johannesburg.

The State Department told Congress on Monday that it will admit up to 17,500 Afrikaners — a group of white South Africans descended mainly from Dutch

settlers — as refugees through the fiscal year that ends in September.

The administration initially indicated that it would only admit up to 7,500, mostly Afrikaners, in that time period, but said Monday that “unforeseen developments in South Africa created an emergency refugee situation.”

The administration’s plans were outlined in an emergency State Department notice sent to Congress on Monday evening and obtained by The Associated Press.

CNN first reported the new refugee levels.

Under law, the administration is required to inform lawmakers about refugee levels for each fiscal year and to consult with them.

Administration officials are slated to meet with Congress for the consultation process later this week, according to a congressional aide who was granted anonymity to confirm a private meeting.

UAE: Drones that targeted Barakah nuclear plant came from Iraqi territory

DUBAI: The drones that targeted the United Arab Emirates’ Barakah nuclear power plant all came from Iraq, the country’s Defense Ministry said Tuesday, likely signaling that Iranian-backed Shiite militias launched the assault.

Such militias launched repeated drone attacks targeting Gulf Arab states after Israel and the United States began

their war against Iran back on Feb. 28. Militias in the past have provided Iran a means by which to deflect blame over such attacks.

There were no reported injuries or radiological release at Barakah after the attack, which Emirati officials said hit a generator on the facility’s perimeter.

The UAE, which has hosted air defenses and personnel

“THERE WERE NO REPORTED INJURIES OR RADIOLOGICAL RELEASE AT BARAKAH AFTER THE ATTACK”

from Israel, recently accused Iran of launching drone and

missile attacks even after its ceasefire with the US began April 8.

US President Donald Trump said Tuesday he’s willing to give Iran a few days to make progress in peace negotiations before the United States resumes military strikes. Trump said Monday he was pulling back from plans to launch strikes Tuesday.

He has repeatedly set

deadlines for Tehran and then backed off.

Tensions have risen over the Strait of Hormuz, a vital energy waterway gripped by Iran while its ports remain under a US naval blockade.

A maritime data firm reported Tuesday that ship traffic through the strait more than doubled last week, but still remains a fraction of its pre-war levels.

Trump told reporters at the White House he “was an hour away from making the decision” to launch a new round of strikes and end the fragile ceasefire before he called off the attack Monday.

Trump didn’t set a firm deadline for Iran on Tuesday, at first saying he was giving Tehran “two or three days.” He then said Iran could have until “maybe early next week.”

Climate report says world won’t get as hot as feared but will pass warming limit

The Paris pact in 2015 set a goal of limiting warming to 1.5 degrees Celsius

WASHINGTON: Scientists are jettisoning their worst and best case scenarios for a warming world as no longer plausible.

That shows how modest gains in the fight to curb climate change have dialed back the most catastrophic of future heating but also confirmed that there’s no chance to limit warming to the international goal set in 2015. Researchers’ new list of seven plausible carbon pollution scenarios for the future are pushing aside two staples of climate policy: the extremes on either end.

The extremes have become less probable in the past several years because of how we power our world. Carbon dioxide, released from the burning of gas, oil and coal, is chiefly responsible for warming.

Increasing use of green energies, like solar, wind and geothermal, which don’t emit carbon dioxide, have lowered top end carbon pollution projections.

However, because those



Takeaways

- » The extremes have become less probable in the past several years because of how we power our world
- » The new proposed worst case scenario has an end-of-the-century warming of about 3.5 degrees Celsius

changes haven’t been fast enough, the bottom end projections have risen.

The Paris climate agreement in 2015 set a goal of limiting warming to 1.5 degrees Celsius (2.7 degrees Fahrenheit) since pre-industrial times, or the mid-1800s, giving rise to the mantra “1.5 to stay alive,” but now scientists say that even their best case scenario still shoots past that signature

temperature mark.

On the other end, those same new scenarios no longer include the coal-heavy future that would lead to 4.5 degrees Celsius (8.1 degrees Fahrenheit) of warming by 2100, a scary scenario that many scientific studies used in their future projections.

The new proposed worst case scenario has an end-of-the-century warming of

about 3.5 degrees Celsius (6.3 degrees Fahrenheit), a full degree (1.8 degrees Fahrenheit) less than the old scenario, while the updated best case future is a couple tenths of a degree Celsius (0.36 degrees Fahrenheit) warmer than previously theorized, squeezing past the Paris goal, said climate scientist Detlef Van Vuuren of Utrecht University, lead author of a recent study laying out future scenarios.

“There is kind of a narrowing of the futures. It cannot be as bad as we thought, but it cannot be as good as we hoped,” said Johan Rockström, director of the Potsdam Institute for Climate Impact Research in Germany.

The scenarios include a “middle” one where by the end of the century the world warms 3 degrees Celsius (5.4 degrees Fahrenheit) above pre-industrial times, which is roughly the path society is currently on, scientists said.

World Briefs

GOVT DECIDES TO PROVIDE MONTHLY RS 15,000 TO LANDLESS SQUATTERS

KATHMANDU: The Nepal government led by Prime Minister Balendra Shah on Tuesday decided to provide Rs 15,000 in rehabilitation support to each landless and squatter family displaced from riverbank settlements in Kathmandu. The Council of Ministers on Tuesday decided to provide monthly funds for the next three months as temporary shelter costs for every family removed from the banks of the Bagmati River and other public lands. The Cabinet also decided to provide Rs 25,000 in a lump sum for rehabilitation to each family after verifying the details of squatters living on the banks of rivers and on public land in the Kathmandu Valley.

BLAST OUTSIDE A SYRIAN DEFENSE MINISTRY BUILDING KILLS A SOLDIER

DAMASCUS: A bomb exploded outside a Defence Ministry building in the Syrian capital on Tuesday, killing one soldier and wounding about a dozen other people, the ministry and state media reported. The Defence Ministry said in a terse statement that soldiers discovered a bomb that was ready to be detonated in the central Bab Sharqi district of Damascus. As they were dismantling it, a car exploded nearby, killing a member of the military and wounding the others. The ministry said the blast occurred outside a building linked to the Defense Ministry.

India's Inflation Puzzle: How will fuel price increase play out

Rs 4/litre hike in fuel prices in 2 installments is likely to have an impact on retail inflation that could soon spill over into household budgets

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India's inflation debate appears to be entering a complicated phase. On the surface, retail inflation appears under control, giving consumers and policymakers some relief. But beneath that, wholesale prices rose sharply in April, even before petrol and diesel prices were increased.

The Rs 4 per litre increase in fuel prices in two installments is likely to have an impact on retail inflation that could soon spill over into household budgets. According to various estimates the impact could be around 20 basispoints (bps).

WHAT ARE CPI- AND WPI-BASED INFLATION?

Consumer Price Index (CPI): CPI measures the change in prices paid by consumers for everyday goods and services such as food, housing, transport, healthcare, and education. It is the RBI's primary inflation gauge for monetary policy. Simply put, CPI reflects the inflation ordinary households feel.

Wholesale Price Index (WPI): WPI tracks price movements at the wholesale or producer level before goods reach consumers. It captures changes in prices of fuel, raw materials, metals, chemicals and manufactured products. WPI is often seen as an early warning signal



Petrol, diesel don't have a standalone category in CPI basket, but are captured under 'fuel & power' category

because rising producer costs eventually get passed on to consumers.

APRIL INFLATION NUMBERS?

India's retail inflation, measured by CPI, rose modestly to 3.48 per cent in April 2026 from 3.40 per cent in March, remaining below the RBI's medium-term target of 4 per cent. Food inflation edged up to 4.2 per cent, while core inflation remained relatively stable. Wholesale inflation, however, painted a dramatically different picture.

WPI inflation surged to 8.3 per cent in April -- a 42-month high -- from 3.88 per cent in March, driven largely by soaring

Highlights

» Fuel and power basket carry a much higher weight in the WPI

» In contrast, CPI gives a much larger weight to food and services, while fuel, gas and electricity have a relatively smaller share

» Economists expect wholesale inflation to remain high in the near term and touch 9 per cent in May

fuel and energy prices following the Middle East conflict and disruptions to crude oil supplies. The biggest jump came from the fuel and power category, where inflation shot up to 24.71 per cent from just 1.05 per cent a month earlier. Crude petroleum inflation climbed more than 88 per cent.

FUEL WEIGHT IN WPI, CPI?

Petrol and diesel do not have a standalone category in the CPI basket, but are captured under the broader 'transport and communication' component and 'fuel and power' category. Petrol and diesel carry relatively smaller but still significant weights through transport-

related items, and economists say fuel price hikes have a wider indirect impact because they raise freight, logistics and input costs across sectors.

Fuel has a much bigger role in the WPI. Fuel and power category weight is around 13.15 per cent in WPI.

Even though petrol's direct CPI weight is low, fuel prices have a powerful second-round effect across the economy. Higher fuel prices increase transport costs, freight rates, food distribution expenses, farm input costs, manufacturing costs, airline and logistics expenses.

Diesel is especially important because it is India's most-used fuel (around 40 per cent). It powers trucks, buses, agricultural pumps, generators, industrial transport networks. That means a sustained fuel price rise eventually pushes up prices of vegetables, milk, packaged goods, cement, steel, and services.

WHY IS THERE A SHARP DIVERGENCE BETWEEN WPI AND CPI INFLATION?

WPI inflation is more sensitive to global commodity price movements and fuel and power basket carry a much higher weight in the WPI. Oil price shock amid the West Asia war has spiked April WPI inflation. In contrast, CPI measures retail

prices. It gives a much larger weight to food and services (housing, healthcare, education and transport), while fuel, gas and electricity have a relatively smaller share. Moreover, higher wholesale costs often take time to fully pass through to retail consumers, resulting in a temporary divergence between WPI and CPI inflation.

WHAT IS THE EXPECTATION OF FUTURE INFLATION TRAJECTORY?

Economists expect wholesale inflation to remain high in the near term and touch 9 per cent in May as the West Asia crisis continues to keep global crude and commodity prices elevated.

The high global prices would gradually feed into domestic fuel, manufacturing and transport costs.

Retail inflation is expected to edge higher in May as costlier fuel, food, transportation, and manufactured goods begin feeding into retail prices. Petrol and diesel prices were raised by Rs 3/litre — the first time in four years — adding to inflationary pressures.

Economists said the full impact of the fuel price hike, along with the recent increase in milk prices, is likely to be fully reflected in June CPI inflation data, which will b

Markets decline on sell-off in blue-chip HDFC Bank & RIL

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Equity benchmarks Sensex and Nifty ended lower on Tuesday due to a fag-end sell-off in blue-chip stocks HDFC Bank and Reliance Industries Ltd, as concerns rose over the rupee hitting a new record low.

Elevated global crude prices tracking geopolitical uncertainties also impacted market sentiment, but robust buying in IT stocks restricted the fall in indices, traders said.

After remaining in the positive territory for the most part of the session, the BSE Sensex suddenly came under selling pressure towards the end, declining 114.19 points, or 0.15 per cent, to settle at 75,200.85.

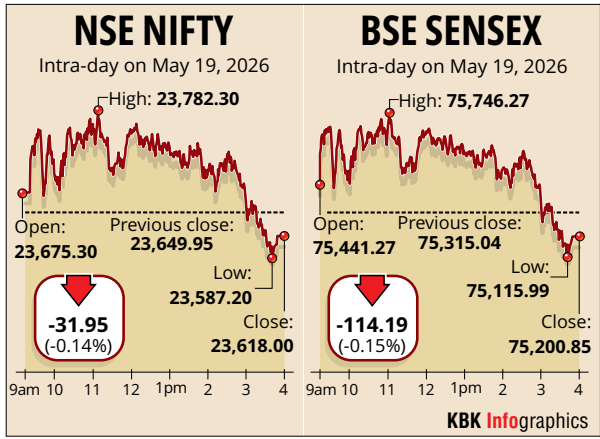
During the day, it surged 431.23 points, or 0.57 per cent, to 75,746.27 after US President Donald Trump said he had halted fresh strikes on Iran at the request of Qatar, Saudi Arabia and the UAE, asserting that serious discussions were underway with Tehran that could lead to an acceptable deal.

The 50-share NSE Nifty dipped 31.95 points, or 0.14 per cent, to end at 23,618.

From the Sensex firms, Kotak Mahindra Bank, Ultra-Tech Cement, Titan, Adani Ports, Bharti Airtel and Sun Pharma were among the biggest laggards.

Infosys, HCL Tech, Tech Mahindra, Eternal and Tata Consultancy Services were among the major winners.

The BSE SmallCap Select index jumped 1.39 per cent, and the MidCap Select index



From Sensex pack, Kotak Mahindra Bank, UltraTech Cement, Titan, Adani Ports, Bharti Airtel & Sun Pharma were among the biggest laggards

went up by 0.93 per cent.

Among sectoral indices, BSE Top 10 Banks declined 0.55 per cent, Private Banks index (0.54 per cent), Services (0.30 per cent), Metal 90.26 per cent) and Telecommunication (0.21 per cent).

Focused IT jumped 3.25 per cent, IT (3.22 per cent), Realty (1.35 per cent), Utilities (0.67 per cent) and Consumer Discretionary (0.60 per cent).

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, traded 1.80 per cent lower at \$110 per barrel.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) bought equities worth Rs 2,813.69 crore on

Monday, according to exchange data.

The majority of Adani Group stocks ended higher after the US Department of Justice permanently dropped all criminal charges against business tycoon Gautam Adani and his nephew Sagar, bringing a high-profile securities and wire fraud case in New York to a complete close after prosecutors concluded they could not sustain the allegations.

In Asian markets, South Korea's benchmark Kospi and Japan's Nikkei 225 index ended lower, while Shanghai's SSE Composite index and Hong Kong's Hang Seng index settled higher.

Markets in Europe were trading in positive territory.

In the previous session on Monday, the BSE benchmark increased by 77.05 points, or 0.10 per cent, to settle at 75,315.04.

The Nifty edged higher by 6.45 points, or 0.03 per cent, to end at 23,649.95.

RBI cancels licence of The Yashwant Co-op Bank

MUMBAI: The RBI on Tuesday said it has cancelled the licence of The Yashwant Co-operative Bank, Phaltan, Maharashtra, as the lender does not have adequate capital and earning prospects.

The Commissioner for Cooperation and Registrar of Cooperative Societies, Maharashtra, has also been requested to issue an order for winding up the bank and appoint a liquidator for the bank, the RBI said.

On liquidation, every depositor would be entitled to receiving deposit insurance claim amount of his/her deposits up to Rs 5 lakh from Deposit Insurance and Credit Guarantee Corporation (DICGC).

As per the data submitted by the bank, about 99.02 per cent of the depositors were entitled to receive full amount of their deposits, the RBI said.

As on April 20, 2026, DICGC has already paid Rs 106.96 crore.

Giving reasons for cancellation of the licence, the RBI said the bank has failed to comply with certain requirements under the Banking Regulation Act.

"The bank with its present financial position would be unable to pay its present depositors in full," it said, adding that continuance of the bank will be prejudicial to the interests of its depositors.

PTI

India's edible oil imports rise 3% in FY26 on Nepal duty-free surge: SEA

NEW DELHI: India's edible oil imports rose 3 per cent to 166.51 lakh tonnes in the 2025-26 fiscal year, driven largely by a sharp jump in duty-free imports from Nepal, industry body Solvent Extractors' Association of India (SEA) said on Tuesday.

Imports had stood at 161.82 lakh tonnes in the prior fiscal year.

Nepal, which enjoys zero-duty access to Indian markets under the South Asian Free Trade Area (SAFTA) agreement, exported 7.36 lakh tonnes of edible oils to India during the year, more than double the 3.45 lakh tonnes shipped in the previous fiscal, a rise of 113 per cent.

Refined soybean oil made up the bulk of Nepal's exports



to India, with smaller volumes of sunflower oil, RBD Palmolein and rapeseed oil also traded.

"The surge in duty-free imports of refined oils from Nepal substantially contributed to the increase in India's total edible oil imports during the year," SEA said in a statement.

The association said that without the SAFTA arrangement, overall imports would

likely have fallen short of the previous year's level despite rising domestic demand, even as higher international prices and a weaker rupee against the dollar increased import costs.

India remains heavily dependent on overseas supplies, with domestic production meeting only around 40 per cent of total edible oil requirements.

Low oilseed yields, fragmented landholdings, limited irrigation and a policy tilt toward wheat and rice cultivation have constrained domestic output growth, SEA said.

The association called for steps to boost oilseed productivity and encourage domestic value addition to reduce long-term import reliance.

PTI

Sebi proposes revamp of STP framework to cut costs and reduce concentration risk

NEW DELHI: Sebi on Tuesday proposed a revamp of the existing Straight-Through Processing (STP) framework by replacing the current centralised hub-based architecture with a decentralised API-based model to reduce costs, lower latency and improve service delivery for market participants.

In a consultation paper, Sebi proposed doing away with the existing STP Centralised Hub used for transfer of messages between different STP Service Providers (SSPs). Instead, message exchange would take place through direct Application Programming Interface (API)-based connectivity between SSPs.

Under the proposed frame-



work, SSPs catering to different STP users will be required to enable standardised API endpoints based on agreed protocols and data formats. This would facilitate seamless and secure exchange of messages and data without routing them through a centralised hub.

"This would also enhance scalability and cost-effectiveness of STP framework while supporting the transaction volumes of institutional trading,"

Sebi said.

The proposal would not require any change at the level of end users — stock brokers, fund houses, custodians.

It would "likely encourage more SSPs to participate, thereby mitigating the concentration risk with single large SSP and improving value added services by SSPs to STP users", Sebi said.

STP enables automated end-to-end processing of financial transactions and is used for the exchange of various messages among market participants, including Electronic Contract Notes (ECNs).

Sebi said an analysis of STP traffic between April 1 and December 31, 2025 showed that 95-99 per cent of all STP

messages were routed through a single SSP, creating significant concentration risk.

Further, because inter-SSP messages currently pass through a single entity -- the STP Hub -- the system is exposed to a potential single point of failure.

The regulator noted that the cost and latency associated with routing messages through the hub may incentivise market participants to consolidate operations with one SSP, worsening concentration risk.

At the same time, the negligible volume of traffic passing through the STP Hub suggests that it is no longer serving its intended purpose of enabling broad-based interoperability, Sebi said.

PTI

VIT alumnus Saurabh Kumar Pal bags 110th rank in UPSC Indian Forest Service Exam

VELLORE: Saurabh Kumar Pal, an alumnus of Vellore Institute of Technology (VIT), has secured the 110th rank in the Indian Forest Service (IFoS) examination conducted by the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC).

Hailing from Prayagraj in Uttar Pradesh, Saurabh graduated with a B.Tech degree in Computer Science from VIT in 2022.

He dedicated himself to preparing for the Indian Forest Service examination after completing his engineering studies.

The final results of the IFoS examination were announced

recently, with Saurabh Kumar Pal achieving an impressive All India rank of 110.

VIT Chancellor Dr. G. Viswanathan, along with Vice presidents Sankar Viswanathan and Sekar Viswanathan, congratulated the young achiever and extended their best wishes.

"VIT's alumni continue to excel in national-level competitive examinations, bringing immense pride to the institution," said Dr. G. Viswanathan.

"Saurabh Kumar Pal's success is a shining example for young engineers from technical backgrounds who aspire to take up administrative and civil services roles."

MPOST

UPI drives 85.5% of India's payments in 2nd half of 2025, says RBI report

NEW DELHI: India's digital payments ecosystem is increasingly dominated by low-value, everyday transactions routed through UPI, while high-value money movement continues to rely on RTGS, according to the latest RBI Payments System Report.

UPI accounted for 85.5 per cent of total payment transaction volumes during the second half of 2025, cementing its position as India's default payment method. However, despite handling the bulk of transactions, UPI contributed only 9.5 per cent of total transaction value.

In contrast, the Real Time Gross Settlement (RTGS) system processed just 0.1 per cent of transaction volumes but

accounted for 68.6 per cent of total payment value, reflecting its continued dominance in large corporate and institutional transfers.

The RBI report highlighted a sharp decline in debit card usage amid the rapid rise of UPI, digital wallets and credit cards.

Debit card transaction volumes fell 67 per cent from 4.087 billion in 2021 to 1.336 billion in 2025, while transaction value declined from Rs 7.4 lakh crore to Rs 4.5 lakh crore. "While the decline in debit card transactions is potentially driven by the rise of digital wallets, UPI and credit card adoption, debit cards remain more widely held than credit cards," the RBI said.

Credit card usage, meanwhile,

more than doubled during the period. Transaction volumes rose from 2.16 billion in 2021 to 5.7 billion in 2025, while transaction value surged from Rs 8.9 lakh crore to Rs 23.2 lakh crore.

The report said India's payments ecosystem has effectively split into two layers — UPI powering mass retail payments such as groceries, utility bills and peer-to-peer transfers, while RTGS handles high-ticket banking and institutional transactions. Digital payments now account for 99.8 per cent of total transaction volume and 97.7 per cent of total transaction value in India, underlining the country's rapid transition towards a nearly fully digital payments economy.

AGENCIES

Gold rebounds ₹800 to ₹1.63 lakh/10 grams, silver falls to ₹2,71,000 per kg

NEW DELHI: Gold prices rebounded by Rs 800 to Rs 1.63 lakh per 10 grams in the national capital on Tuesday, as signs of a breakthrough in US-Iran negotiations eased concerns over inflation pressure.

According to local marketmen, the yellow metal of 99.9 per cent purity rose Rs 800 to Rs 1,63,600 per 10 grams (inclusive of all taxes) from Monday's closing level of Rs 1,62,800 per 10 grams.

However, silver prices dropped by Rs 5,000 to Rs 2,71,000 per kilogram (in-

sive of all taxes) due to weak industrial demand and subdued trends in the global markets.

In the international market, spot gold was trading 0.47 per cent lower at \$4,544.78 per ounce, while silver declined 2.01 per cent to \$76.12 per ounce.

Spot gold prices are trading lower at around \$4,540 per ounce as oil prices, though having eased slightly, remain elevated, Praveen Singh, Head of commodities at Mirae Asset ShareKhan, said.

PTI

POWERGRID ANALYSTS MEET



Power Grid Corporation of India Limited (POWERGRID) conducted its analysts meet at Mumbai. Vamsi Rama Mohan Burra, CMD POWERGRID in presence of G Ravisankar, Director (Finance), Dr. Yatindra Dwivedi, Director (Personnel), Naveen Srivastava, Director (Operations), and senior officials interacted with the Analysts. As of 30th April 2026, POWERGRID has commissioned and is operating 291 Sub-Stations and more than 1,85,102 km transmission lines and 6,28,516 MVA of transformation capacity.

MPOST

'India-EU FTA opens market access for 99.5% of Indian exports'

The combined imports of India & the EU represent roughly one-third of global trade in goods & services, Jain said

NEW DELHI: India has crossed a major milestone in its trade negotiations with the European Union, but the real challenge now lies in converting the free trade agreement (FTA) into tangible gains for businesses, exporters and workers, senior officials and industry leaders said on Tuesday.

"We have climbed the mountain of negotiations," Additional Secretary in the Commerce Ministry Darpan Jain said at a conference organised by FICCI and the Centre for Trade and Investment Law. "The bigger climb



begins now — making it work on the ground for every exporter, every investor and every job creator across India and Europe."

Jain, India's lead nego-

CLOSER LOOK

» 'We have climbed the mountain of negotiations. The bigger climb begins now — making it work on ground'

» He pointed out that India exports only \$7.2 billion worth of textiles to the EU despite the bloc importing \$263 billion annually

» While gems and jewellery exports stand at \$2.7 billion against EU imports of \$80 billion

tiator for the India-US and India-EU FTAs, said 99.5 per cent of Indian exports would receive preferential tariff treatment under the pact announced in January 2026.

Goods worth about \$33 billion in labour-intensive sectors such as apparel, textiles, leather, footwear, and gems and jewellery — currently subject to EU duties of 10-14 per cent

and up to 26 per cent in some categories — will see tariffs eliminated.

Highlighting the scale of the opportunity, Jain said the combined imports of India and the EU account for nearly one-third of global trade in goods and services.

He pointed out that India exports only \$7.2 billion worth of textiles to the EU despite the bloc importing \$263 billion annually, while gems and jewellery exports stand at \$2.7 billion against EU imports of \$80 billion.

On services, Jain said India's exports had reached \$421 bil-

lion this financial year, close to goods exports of \$441 billion. The agreement covers 144 of 155 EU services sub-sectors and includes mobility provisions for IT professionals and intra-corporate transferees, along with a first-of-its-kind annexure for Ayurveda practitioners.

FICCI Secretary General Anant Swarup said the EU accounts for nearly 12 per cent of India's merchant-dise trade. "The task before us is to convert these agreements into practical gains for industry, especially for exporters, MSMEs and service providers," he said.

MPOST

KG-basin dispute: SC starts hearing on RIL’s appeal against HC order

RIL operates KG-D6 with 60% stake, followed by BP at 30% & Niko with 10%

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday commenced final hearing on appeals of Reliance Industries Limited (RIL) and two other foreign firms challenging a Delhi High Court verdict that set aside an arbitral award in their favour in the Krishna-Godavari Basin gas migration dispute with the Centre.

RIL, BP Exploration (Alpha) Limited and Niko (NECO) Limited have assailed the February 14, 2025 order of the high court setting aside an order of the single judge bench which had upheld the arbitral award in favour of RIL and its two partners for allegedly siphoning off gas from deposits they had no right to exploit.

In July 2018, an international arbitration tribunal rejected the Indian government’s claim of \$1.55 billion against RIL and its partners for allegedly siphoning gas from deposits they had no right to exploit.

The three-member arbitral panel by a majority of 2-1 had also awarded \$8.3 million compensation to the three partners, Reliance had said in a regulatory filing.

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and justices Joymalya Bagchi and Vipul M Pancholi heard senior advo-



In July 2018, an international arbitration tribunal rejected the Indian government’s claim of \$1.55 billion against RIL

cate Abhishek Singhvi on behalf of RIL.

Singhvi, representing RIL, refuted the Centre’s claim that RIL “siphoned” gas that had migrated from the neighbouring blocks of state-owned ONGC into RIL’s KG-D6 block. He said that the gas flow was a purely physical phenomenon driven by pressure differentials, comparing it to “osmosis”.

The senior lawyer emphasized that the “theft” allegation was technically and legally flawed. He said while the government contributed zero capital and bore no exploration risk, it remained the ultimate benefi-

Highlights

- » Delhi HC verdict set aside arbitral award in favour of RIL in the KG-Basin gas migration dispute with the Centre
- » A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant & justices Joymalya Bagchi & Vipul M Pancholi heard Abhishek Singhvi on behalf of RIL
- » The senior lawyer emphasized that the “theft” allegation was technically and legally flawed

ciary of all extracted gas.

“The gas belongs to the government. It is the same receiver,” Singhvi said, adding that the government receives royalties and profit shares regardless of which block the gas originated from. He said that RIL spent \$7.4 billion on an ultra-deep-water project, a “frontier of sub-sea engineering” where other operators, including ONGC had struggled to produce for years.

He said by supplying gas to priority sectors like fertilizer and power at government-fixed prices (\$2.8 to the project saved India \$13.7 billion in subsidies).

“It is the single largest suc-

cess story in domestic gas production, contributing 30 percent of India’s output. Yet, I stand accused of theft,” Singhvi said.

The hearing on the pleas would commence on Wednesday.

Earlier, a division bench of the high court had allowed the appeal of the central government challenging the May 9, 2023 judgment of a single-judge which was passed in favour of Mukesh Ambani-owned RIL.

The single judge, while upholding the arbitral award, had said it was not persuaded to hold that the conclusions drawn by the arbitral tribunal were such that no reasonable person would reach. The oil ministry on November 4, 2016, slapped a demand of \$1.47 billion on Reliance-BP-Niko combine for producing in seven years ending March 31, 2016 about 338.332 million British thermal units of gas that had seeped or migrated from ONGC’s blocks into their adjoining KG-D6 in the Bay of Bengal.

After deducting \$71.71 million royalty paid on the gas produced and adding an interest at the rate of LIBOR plus 2 per cent, totalling \$149.86 million, a total demand of \$1.55 billion was made on Reliance, BP and Niko. Reliance had disputed the government’s demand as

being based on a “misreading and misinterpretation of key elements of the PSC”, and it said that such a demand was without precedent in the oil and gas industry.

It on November 11, 2016, slapped an arbitration notice. Reliance is the operator of the KG-D6 block with 60 per cent interest while BP holds 30 per cent. The remaining 10 per cent is with Niko Resources.

The government’s compensation claim flowed from the report of the Justice (ret’d) A P Shah Committee.

The Shah panel, in its August 28, 2016, report, concluded that there has been “unjust enrichment” to the contractor of the block KG-DWN-98/3 (KG-D6) due to the production of the migrated gas from ONGC’s blocks KG-DWN-98/2 and Godavari PML. Originally, ONGC had sued Reliance for producing gas that had migrated from its blocks KG-DWN-98/2 (KG-D5) and Godavari PML in the KG basin to adjoining KG-D6 block of Reliance.

Under the direction of the Delhi High Court, the government had appointed a one-man committee under retired Justice A P Shah to go into the issue. Shah, however, said the compensation should go to the government as it is the owner of all unproduced natural resources.

EPFO subscribers to soon withdraw EPF money via UPI

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: EPFO subscribers will soon be able to withdraw their employees’ provident fund and transfer it directly to their bank accounts through the UPI payment gateway, as testing of the facility has been completed, said Labour Minister Mansukh Mandaviya.

Talking to reporters, the minister stated that the Employees Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) is taking various initiatives to improve the quality of service delivery.

“We have completed the testing of the facility where members can withdraw EPF (employees’ provident fund) through the use of the UPI payment gateway. The withdrawn amount will be directly transferred into the bank account of the member,” Mandaviya said on Tuesday.

The labour ministry has been working on a project where a certain proportion of the EPF will be frozen, and a large chunk will be available for withdrawal through their bank account using UPI. Subscribers will be able to see the eligible EPF balance available to transfer into their seeded bank accounts.

They will be allowed to use their linked UPI pin for completing the transaction to ensure a secure transfer of money into their bank accounts. Once the money is transferred into bank accounts, members can use the money as they want, like making payments electronically



Labour Minister Mansukh Mandaviya

At present, EPFO members have to apply for withdrawal claims to access their EPF money, which is time-consuming

or withdrawing through bank ATMs using debit cards.

The Employees’ Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) has been trying to resolve software glitches for the smooth implementation of this system, which will benefit over seven crore members.

At present, EPFO members have to apply for withdrawal claims to access their EPF money, which is time-consuming. Under the auto-settlement mode, the withdrawal claims are settled electronically without manual intervention within three days of filing the application form. The limit of this auto-settlement mode has already been raised to Rs 5 lakh from the existing Rs 1 lakh.

This facilitates a large number of EPFO members to access their EPF money within three days for illness, education, marriage, and housing purposes.

The minister informed that the EPFO has taken the initiative to use WhatsApp for enhancing outreach and streamlining member services.

EPFO has planned to use the WhatsApp platform with the objective of enhancing outreach and streamlining member services. The major reasons for using the WhatsApp channel for communications include its use by most mobile users.

Under this facility, the members can simply type ‘Hello’ to EPFO’s registered WhatsApp number, which is verified by a green tick mark for safety and assurance, to initiate the conversation with EPFO.

They can also choose to receive messages from EPFO on their mobile number registered with EPFO. All communication will be through the local/ vernacular language, enabling greater comfort for members to engage with EPFO in their language.

The members will have 24/7 access, and the automated systems can handle repetitive queries around the clock.

The initiative will focus on members eligible under PMV-BRY, who have pending gaps, such as non-completion of Aadhaar Authentication via UIDAI’s Face Authentication technology (EAT) or non-enablement of DBT for their Aadhaar-linked bank account.

BPCL reports net profit of ₹3,191.49 cr in Q4

For the fiscal year ended March 31, BPCL’s net profit soared 75 per cent to Rs 23,303.22 crore from Rs 13,275.26 crore in the previous FY25

NEW DELHI: State-owned Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd (BPCL) on Tuesday reported a flat net profit in the quarter ended March 31 after it took an impairment loss of Rs 4,349 crore on its upstream assets.

Net profit of Rs 3,191.49 crore in January-March - the fourth quarter of the 2025-26 fiscal year - compared with Rs 3,214.06 crore earning in the same period a year back and Rs 7,545.27 crore profit of the preceding quarter, according to a stock exchange filing of BPCL.

The flat year-on-year growth came after it took an impairment on investment its subsidiary has made in oil and gas blocks globally and in India.

“During FY26, (BPCL’s



wholly-owned upstream subsidiary) Bharat PetroResources Ltd has impaired investments due to change in prospects of its blocks,” it said. Accordingly, “an impairment loss of Rs 4,349.13 crore has been recognised based on the value of in use of assets as on March 31, 2026.”

The gross carrying value of

upstream investment has come down from Rs 15,426.37 crore to Rs 11,313.83 crore.

For the fiscal year ended March 31, BPCL’s net profit soared 75 per cent to Rs 23,303.22 crore from Rs 13,275.26 crore in the previous FY25.

The quarterly profit came

despite the company suffering huge losses on selling petrol, diesel, and cooking gas LPG below cost in March, as it, along with other state-owned fuel retailers, insulated the domestic market from volatility that hit the international market after the start of the West Asia conflict. The full impact of the ongoing war-driven disruption will be visible in Q1 FY27.

Also, the company had an under-recovery of Rs 12,318.52 crore in FY26 on selling domestic cooking gas LPG below cost. This has to be made good by the government by way of subsidy but no timelines for the payout has been intimated. Revenue from operations came in at Rs 1.34 lakh crore in Q4 and Rs 5.22 lakh crore in FY26. PTI

BSE may replace IT major Wipro in Nifty50 September rebalancing

NEW DELHI: Domestic brokerage Axis Capital has projected that India’s oldest stock exchange, BSE, could replace IT major Wipro in the NSE’s semi-annual index rebalancing, expected to be announced in the second half of August and implemented from September 30, 2026.

The Index Maintenance Sub-Committee considers six-month average data between February 1 and July 31 to decide inclusions and exclusions. Based on data available from February 1 to May 15, Axis Capital expects one change in the Nifty50, five changes in the Nifty Next 50 and no changes in the Bank Nifty.

If included in the Nifty50, BSE may attract inflows of \$657 million, with index funds estimated to purchase 15.7 mil-



lion shares. In contrast, Wipro could witness outflows of \$225 million, resulting in index funds selling nearly 114.2 million shares.

Wipro shares have remained under pressure, falling 20 per cent over the past six months and 27 per cent since the start of the year.

Ahead of the reshuffle, Wipro, Polycab India, Hitachi Energy India, Indian Bank and ICICI Prudential As-set Management Company are seen as key contenders for inclusion in

the Nifty Next 50 index.

Meanwhile, Indian Hotels Company, REC, Shree Cement, Zydu Lifesciences and Lodha Developers are considered the most likely candidates for exclusion.

BSE reported a consolidated net profit of Rs 797 crore for the March quarter of FY26, up 61 per cent from Rs 494 crore a year earlier.

Revenue for Q4FY26 surged 85 per cent year-on-year to Rs 1,564 crore from Rs 847 crore. Sequentially, net profit rose 32 per cent from Rs 602 crore in Q3FY26, while revenue increased 26 per cent from Rs 1,244 crore in the October-December quarter.

For FY26, BSE posted consolidated revenue of Rs 5,148 crore, with EBITDA at Rs 3,393 crore and EBITDA margins of 48 per cent. AGENCIES

More than 8,800 cases admitted under IBC, creditors realise over ₹4.11 lakh cr till Dec 2025

NEW DELHI: More than 8,800 Corporate Insolvency Resolution Processes (CIRPs) were admitted under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC) till December 2025, with creditors recovering over Rs 4.11 lakh crore through approved resolution plans, Financial Services Secretary M Nagaraju said on Tuesday.

Addressing a workshop on the Insolvency and Bankruptcy (Amendment) Act, 2026, Nagaraju said over 4,000 corporate debtors have been rescued through resolution, settlements, withdrawals and appeal-related closures.

The finance ministry said the workshop aimed to discuss the impact of recent IBC



amendments on the banking sector and improve stakeholder understanding of the amended provisions.

Nagaraju highlighted the IBC’s role in creating a time-bound and creditor-driven insolvency resolution framework.

He said the Code has strengthened repayment discipline and shifted the focus from liquidation to revival and

value maximisation of stressed businesses.

Referring to amendments on group insolvency, cross-border insolvency and creditor-initiated insolvency resolution processes, he said the reforms would strengthen the framework further and help address delays in resolution.

Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India (IBBI) Chairperson Ravi Mital said the IBC has enhanced institutional capacity, creditor confidence and transparency in insolvency proceedings.

He added that the latest amendments would improve coordination among stakeholders and ensure the framework re-mains efficient and

future-ready.

The workshop included presentations by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA) and IBBI on the amendments and their implications for the Committee of Creditors (CoC) and other stakeholders.

Senior officials from MCA, IBBI, public sector banks, financial institutions and legal experts attended the event.

Department of Financial Services Special Secretary Sanjay Lohiya, in his closing remarks, stressed the need to address delays, capacity constraints and prolonged litigation, while noting that the IBC has significantly improved ease of doing business in India. AGENCIES

Industry should turn global uncertainties into opportunities & avoid panic, says Goyal

NEW DELHI: Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal on Tuesday said Indian businesses should turn the current global economic uncertainties into opportunities for growth and not panic over the situation.

He said the present global situation and geopolitical uncertainties should be viewed as an opportunity for India to strengthen business processes, undertake faster reforms, build greater resilience and strengthen supply chains.

“India and Prime Minister (Narendra) Modi have never let a crisis go by and the situation in the world is truly an oppor-

tunity, a moment of uncertainty that we should engage more deeply with. Find ways to strengthen our business processes and prepare ourselves on these uncertain times for brighter and better future,” he said here at Assocham’s India Business Reform Summit 2026.

He added that lessons learnt during the COVID period had demonstrated the effectiveness of digital engagement and remote working models.

“In such a situation, we do not need to panic,” Goyal said adding the West Asia crisis, and emerging technologies like AI bring opportunities for Indian

industry to seize. Goyal urged industry to adopt greater efficiency and reduce waste by learning from global best practices, including Japanese manufacturing systems.

Despite global challenges such as tariffs, the Ukraine conflict and the West Asia crisis, India’s exports reached an all-time high of \$863 billion last fiscal year, with growth recorded in both merchandise and services exports. Free trade agreements, finalised by India are opening doors for greater engagement which needs to be leveraged for attracting investments and increasing exports rather

than allowing imports alone to rise.

Referring to suggestions received during discussions with industry representatives, he said the government is examining the possibility of establishing a single body at industrial parks to function as a one-stop shop for all central and state approvals. He also urged greater engagement from the private sector in improving government systems, while expressing concern that the national single-window system had not received adequate participation and feedback from the industry. PTI

Ind-Ra projects GDP growth to slow to 6.7% in current fiscal on geopolitical uncertainty

Ind-Ra’s projection compares to 6.9% GDP growth projection by the RBI

NEW DELHI: India Ratings & Research (Ind-Ra) on Tuesday projected India’s economic growth to decelerate to 6.7 per cent in FY27 on slowdown in demand & supply and retail inflation is expected to stay within the RBI’s tolerance band at 4.4 per cent despite recent fuel price hikes.

Ind-Ra’s projection compares to 6.9 per cent GDP growth and 4.6 per cent inflation projection by the RBI.

The agency believes higher fuel and food prices due to the

West Asia conflict’s uncertainty and the likely impact of evolving El Nino on agriculture from mid-2026 will pull down GDP growth in FY27 to 6.7 per cent.

“Major headwinds include geopolitical developments, particularly the West Asia conflict, high headline inflation, a depreciated currency from weak capital inflows, weaker-than-expected capex especially by the government to reduce fiscal risks, weak global trade growth, strong FY26 growth (base effect), low industrial

production as measured by the Index of Industrial Production (IIP), and notably, the likely El Nino weather pattern from mid-2026,” India Ratings & Research Director - Economics Megha Arora said.

Ind-Ra has assumed average oil prices at \$95/bbl in FY27 and expects the government, oil marketing companies and consumers to share the burden of high global oil prices with consumers sharing the least burden.

It estimates that a \$10/bbl increase in crude oil prices

could reduce GDP growth by 44 bps, while a 10 per cent reduction in capex could lower GDP growth to 6 per cent, Arora said.

Ind-Ra expects the government to announce easy access to credit and measures like credit guarantees as opposed to direct cash transfers to shield people and small industries from the impact of the West Asia crisis.

For Q1 FY27, Ind-Ra estimates GDP growth at 6.7 per cent and said the El Nino impact is likely to be felt more in Q2, as against June quarter. PTI

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Dhirender Yadav, S/o Ram Avadh, R/o H.No. 525, MCD Park, Nangal Thakran, Bawana, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 340/20, U/s 33/58 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Bawana, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Dhirender Yadav** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Dhirender Yadav** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Dhirender Yadav** accused of **FIR No. 340/20, U/s 33/58 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Bawana, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.07.2026**.
By Order - **Sh. Sarthak Panwar**
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
DP/6581/ON/2026 Room No. 114, Rohini Courts, Delhi

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE

The Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer/Const./Northern Railway, DRM Office, New Delhi-110001 invites e-tender under One Packet System for the under noted work:-

1.	Name of work and location	*Design, supply, Erection, Testing, commissioning & modification work of 25 KV single phase ac work of 2/4 Lane ROB's in lieu of Lxing over DLI Divn 1. L-Xing 568 & 576 over NDLS-PWL Section 2. L-Xing 36 spl near Gannaur over Delhi-Ambala section 3. L-Xing 47C near Khukrana over Jind-Panipat Section
2.	Completion period of the work	12 Months
3.	Approx. Cost of work	Rs. 66,23,608.80/-
4.	Earnest Money amount (to be deposited Online)	Rs. 1,32,500/-
5.	Date & Time for submission of E-tender and opening of tender	Tenders may be uploaded up to 15.00 hrs on date 10.06.2026 on IREPS web site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in . The bidders can participate in the e-tender, the tender will be opened at 15.00 hrs soon after dosing of uploading of Tenders on 10.06.2026.
6.	Detailed Tender Notice & Tender Document	The detailed e-tender notice and tender document is available on www.ireps.gov.in . Above tender document will be available for submission of offer on IREPS web site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in from 27.05.2026 to 10.06.2026. All other terms and conditions in respect of above tenders are given in tender document. The detailed tender notice also can be seen on the Notice Board of the above office.

Tender No. 344-R1/Dy.CEE/C/NDLS/2025-26 Dated: 19.05.2026 1671/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

REFURBISHMENT OF 10 NOS. OF INSPECTION CARRIAGE

E-Tender Notice No. DBWS-NIET-07-2026-27 Dated: 15-05-2026.
Works tender through e-tendering system are invited from the competent Firm(s)/Contractor(s) for the work as detailed below:- **Name of the work:** Refurbishment of 10 Nos. of Inspection Carriage (RA) at Dibrugarh Workshop for a period of 1 (One) Year. **Approximate Cost of the work:** ₹4,83,98,762.00/- Inclusive of GST @ 18%. **Earnest Money:** ₹9,68,000/- **Date & time of closing tender:** at 12.00 hrs. & opening at 12.30 hrs. of 06-06-2026. The complete information about the tender document of above e-tender will be available up to 12.00 hrs. of 06-06-2026 in website www.ireps.gov.in

Chief Workshop Manager, Dibrugarh
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
Serving Customers With A Smile

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE

No. DNR/S&T/Sig/2026/5 Dated: 15.05.2026
Divisional Railway Manager (Signal & Telecom), East Central Railway, Danapur Division, for and on behalf of President of India invites tenders on web portal www.ireps.gov.in for the following work:-
1. Name of work with its location : Provision of parallel Server and CMU setup as per RDSO guidelines at Data Logger in S&T Control room and strengthening of existing datalogger network & COA of divisional headquarters at Danapur under East Central Railway. **2. Approx cost of the work :** Rs. 10,14,958.52. **3. Earnest Money :** Rs. 20,30,000/- **4. Last Date & Time of submission :** Up to 15.00 hrs. on 05.06.2026. **5. Opening of tender :** 15.00 hrs. on 05.06.2026. **6. Website particulars where details of the work and criteria can be seen :** www.ireps.gov.in. **7. Address of the office from where detail information can be obtained :** Sr. Divnl. Signal & Telecommunication Engineer, East Central Railway, Danapur.
Note : Any corrigendum if required will be uploaded on above website before 14 days.

Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer
East Central Railway, Danapur
PR/0253/DNR/S&T/T/26-27/36

Form No. INC-26
[Pursuant to rule 30 the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014] Advertisement to be published in the newspaper for change of Registered office of the company from one state to another
BEFORE THE CENTRAL GOVERNMENT NORTHERN REGION

In the matter of sub-section (4) of Section 13 of the Companies Act, 2013 and clause (a) of sub-rule (5) of rule 30 of the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014

AND
In the matter of M/S MANKAMNA GASES (INDIA) PRIVATE LIMITED having its registered office at ROOM MT, KIRTI HOUSE, 1/6 KIRTI NAGAR INDUSTRIAL AREA, NEW DELHI-110015 ...Petitioner

Notice is hereby given in the General Public that the company proposes to change its Regional Director at the address ROC DELHI II, 8TH FLOOR, lok nayak bhawan, kham market, 110003, within fourteen days of the date of publication of this notice with a copy to the applicant company at its registered office address.

For and on behalf of the MANKAMNA GASES (INDIA) PRIVATE LIMITED
Sd/-
JATIN PAUL SINGH SUDAN
DIN: 06426743
Sd/-
GAJAN SINGH SUDAN
DIRECTOR
DIN: 0277510

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Vipin S/o Parveen R/o B-1/138, Ground Floor, Vijay Vihar, Rohini, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 791/2019, U/S 324/34 IPC, PS Raj Park, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Vipin** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Vipin** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Vipin** of **FIR No. 791/2019, U/S 324/34 IPC, PS Raj Park, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **26.06.2026**
By Order,
Ms. Ebbani Aggarwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
North-West. Court No. 107, 1st Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi
DP/6383/OD/2026(Court Matter)

वरिय पुलिस अधीक्षक का कार्यालय
पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर।
आवश्यक सूचना



अज्ञात मृतक पुरुष उम्र-करीब 55 वर्ष।
सर्व साधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि दिनांक-15.05.2026 को बरसोल थानान्तर्गत ग्राम पाथरघाटा जाने वाले मोड़ के पास NH 49 पर एक अज्ञात पुरुष उम्र-करीब 55 वर्ष का शव बरामद हुआ है। जिसके बारे में स्थानीय लोगों एवं ग्रामीणों से पुछताछ किया गया परन्तु शव का पहचान/ शिनाख्त नहीं हो सका है। अज्ञात मृतक पुरुष का इलिया निम्न प्रकार है- उम्र-55 वर्ष, ऊँचाई-करीब 05 फीट, बाल-काला-हल्का उजला, पहनावा-लाल कमीज, हरा रंग का छिद्रदार लुंगी।
अतः आप सभी जन साधारण से अनुरोध है कि यदि उपरोक्त हुलिये के संबंध में किसी प्रकार की जानकारी प्राप्त होती है तो इसकी सूचना वरिय पुलिस अधीक्षक के कार्यालय में निम्नांकित फोन नम्बर पर सूचित करें।
वरिय पुलिस अधीक्षक, पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर : 0657-2431006
पुलिस अधीक्षक (ग्रामीण), पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर : 9470199228
अनुपुषुपदातो, घाटशिला : 9431706485
थाना प्रभारी, बरसोला : 9431706527

वरिय पुलिस अधीक्षक, पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर।
PR 380223 Police(26-27)D

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Auction Notice

No. JHS/Comm/E-Auction/26/147 Date: 19.05.2026
On behalf of The President of India, The Divisional Railway Manager (Commercial) Jhansi invites e-auction as per categories given as under:-

Cat.	Catalogue No.	Asset Details
Parcel	JHS-Leasing-63	1- Train Number 22547 = 01 SLR-F1
		2- Train Number 12279 = 01 SLR-F1
		3- Train Number 12320 = 01 SLR-F1
		4- Train Number 22198 = 01 SLR-F1
		5- Train Number 12198 = 01 SLR-F2
		6- Train Number 11107 = 02 SLR-F1 & R1

Auction Start : 04.06.2026 at 10:30 hrs
Auction End : 04.06.2026 at 12:30 hrs
Note: Prospective bidders are requested to visit e-Auction Leasing module on IREPS website (www.ireps.gov.in). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. 1130/26 (MG)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE
ICICI Bank

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005
The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.
Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited,

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Gaurav/ Harish Kumar/ Jyiva/ Neelam Rani/ Prince Satija/ LBPNP00005110211/ LBPNP00005110214	House Old, No.98/7, B-3-72, 73, 1/3 Part Situated At Mohalla Janakpura, Ward No. 10, Gohana, Sonapat, Haryana- 131001/ 16 May, 2026	January 30, 2026 Rs. 1,26,10,897.47/-	Gohana/ Sonapat (Haryana)/ Delhi & Ncr

The above-mentioned borrower(s)/guarantor(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.
Date: May 20, 2026
Place: Delhi & Ncr
Sincerely Authorised Officer,
For ICICI Bank Ltd.,

PUBLIC NOTICE
ICICI Bank

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi-110005
Notice under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 is being issued by ICICI Bank Ltd. (on the underlying pool assigned to ICICI Bank by Dewan Housing Finance Ltd.) in relation to the enforcement of security concerning a Housing Loan Facility granted pursuant to a Loan agreement entered into between DHFL and the following borrower(s) who has/have defaulted in the repayment of principal and interest towards the Loan Facility(ies) obtained by them from the secured creditor. The Loans have been classified as Non-Performing Assets (NPA). A notice was issued to them at their last known addresses; however, it has returned un-served and hence, they are hereby notified by way of this Public Notice.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower/Co-Borrower/ Guarantor/ Address (DHFL Old LAN & ICICI New LAN)	Property Address of Secured Asset/ Asset to be Enforced	Date of Notice Sent/ Outstanding as on Date of Notice	NPA Date
1.	Gurwinder Singh, Manjit Singh, 4, Near Bus Stand, Ward No. 1, Cheema, Sangrur, Punjab- 148028., A/C No, QZPAT00005024159 & 17800004252	Property Measuring 5 Marla Being 3/10 Share of Property Measuring 17 Marla Comprised In Khata No. 431/812, 813, 814, Murabba And Killu No. 385/5/7/3(0-5), 385/5/7/2(0-5), 385/5/7/1/1(0-5) 5/7/1/2(0-2), Situated At Village Cheema, Tehsil Sunam, District Sangrur, Punjab- 148028.	07/01/2026 Rs. 6,99,422.38/-	11/05/2025

The steps are being taken for substituted service of Notice. The above borrower(s) and/or the guarantor(s) of the Loan (as applicable) is/are advised to make the payments of the outstanding within the period of 60 days from the date of the publication of this Notice else, further steps will be taken as per the provisions of the Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002.
Date: May 20, 2026
Place: Gurgaon
Authorised Officer
Team ICICI Bank

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
P.W.D. KANKER CIRCLE KANKER (C.G.)
E-Procurement Tender Notice

Online tenders arc invited for Construction of Road work ,up to Date 02/06/2026

S. No.	NIT NO.	System Tender No.	Name or work	Probable Amount Contract
1	11	191152	Construction or Kurilsitkur Naili-ynarn Approach Road Length 1,416 km. (Block Kanker)	171.88 Lakhs

All Documents related to Tender are to be submitted by Tenderers online only, failing which the tenderer can not participate in the bidding, for tender details please visit <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in>

Note: CONTRACTOR SUBMIT THE CERTIFICATE REGARDING MACHINERIES & PLANTS AS PER ANNEXURE-G - 7 (d)
Tender Downloaded upto 02-06-2026.

Notes:- 2nd Call.
Sd/-
Superintending Engineer,
Public Works Department
Kanker Circle Kanker

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE

No. DYCE-II-GSU-PRYJ-11-2026 Dated: 15.05.2026
Dy. Chief Engineer-II/GSU/Prayagraj, North Central Railway, acting for and on behalf of the President of India, invites E-tenders for the following work through **Open Tender-Two Packet System**. Bidders will be able to submit their original/revised bids up to closing date and time only. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender and any such manual offer received shall be ignored.

Tender No.: DYCE-II-GSU-PRYJ-11-2026 Approx.Cost of Work (INR): ₹ 33.93 Cr.
Brief Description of work: Appointment of Project Supervision Services Agency (PSSA) for providing project supervision services for projects of various units under CAO/C/RSP for 24 months.

Amount of EMD (INR):	₹ 18,46,500.00	Completion Period: 24 months
Cost of Tender Document: 0.00/-		
Tender Opening date and Time: 23.06.2026, 15:00 Hrs.		

Note :- 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-works tender will be available on website <https://ireps.gov.in> up to 15:00 hrs. on the due date of tender opening. 2. Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above Tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with class III Digital signature certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000, 3. Rate entered into Financial Rate page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head attached by tenderer shall be straight away ignored and shall not be considered. 4. Documents being attached should be signed by the tenderer on its body. 5. In case of any difficulty, helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. 1120/26(DG)
North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
T. Tender No.- 230-Elect/TRD/PRYJ/E-Tender Notice/ 2026/635 Date 15.05.2026

E-Tender Notice

Sr. Divl. Electrical Engineer/TRD/N.C. Rly/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following E-Tender, the details of the tenders are as under:-

T. No.: 230-TRD-WC-1024-2026	
Description of work:	Replacement of overaged/weak Catenary wire in Prayagraj Division.
Advertised Value:	₹ 80,84,490.00
Bid Security:	₹ 1,61,700.00
Completion Period:	12 months
Bidding System:	Single Packet
Tender Closing date & Time:	08.06.2026 & 14.00 Hrs.
Tender Opening date & Time:	08.06.2026 & 15.00 Hrs.

Note:- 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders shall be available on Website www.ireps.gov.in 21 days prior to the opening of the tender. 3. Bids other than in the form of E-Bid shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate. 4. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. 1117/26 FA
North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Vishal, S/o: Umed, R/o: P-141, Krishan Vihar, Sultanpuri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 2282/2022, U/s: 379/411 IPC, Police Station Bawana, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Vishal** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Vishal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Vishal** of **Police Station Bawana, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **04.07.2026**.
By Order
Ms. Bharti Beniwal
LD. JMFC-05, North, 1st Floor, Room No. 114
Rohini Courts, Delhi
DP/6467/ON/2026

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tender Notice

Senior Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/Co-ordination/North Central Railway Prayagraj for and on behalf of the President of India, invite E-TENDER on prescribed form for the following works up to 15:00 hrs. on 09.06.2026. The detail of the Tender is as under :-
Approx. Cost of work (in Rs.) : Rs.61828575.12/- (Rs. Six Crore Eighteen Lakhs Twenty-Eight Thousand Five Hundred TwentyFive & Twelve Paise Only).

Bid Security/Earnest Money (in Rs.) : 1236600.00
Completion Period : 12 Months **Date of Closing of tender : 09.06.2026**
Name of work : "Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract for Frauscher make MSDAC, installed in Kaurara-Chiplayana & branch line section of Sr.DSTE/ALJN of PRYJ division for a period of one year."

Availability of tender form : Tender forms shall be available on www.ireps.gov.in 21 days prior to date of opening of the tender.

Earnest Money to be deposited : The prescribed amount of Earnest Money as mentioned above must be deposited along with the tender form Online through Internet Banking or Online Payment gateway only. The tenderer(s) should note that, in any case, the Earnest Money in any other form than specified above shall not be acceptable. Tenders without earnest money shall be summarily rejected.

Time, date & place of opening of tender : Tender will be opened through E-tender at office of Divisional Railway Manager, Prayagraj on or after pre determined date at 15:30 hours. In case tender opening date happens to be holiday, Tenders will be opened on the next working day.

Validity of Offer : 60 days from the date of opening.

Right of Railway to deal with tender : Railway administration reserves the rights to postpone/modify or to cancel the tender without assigning any reasons. 1124/26 (D)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

APPENDIX IV-A
Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Property

E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.
Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to Sammaan Capital Limited (formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd.) [CIN : L65922DL2005PLC136029] ("Secured Creditor"), the constructive possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on 22.06.2026 from 05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M., for recovery of Rs. 43,96,261/- (Rupees Forty Three Lakh Ninety Six Thousand Two Hundred Sixty One only) i.e. Rs. 41,81,616/- (Rupees Forty One Lakh Eighty One Thousand Six Hundred Sixteen only) pending towards Loan Account No. HHLRHN00515885 and Rs. 2,14,645/- (Rupees Two Lakh Fourteen Thousand Six Hundred Forty Five only) pending towards Loan Account No. HHLRHN00515887, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till 24.05.2026 with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w.e.f. 05.05.2026 along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor from GEETANJALI or GEETANJALI JAINWAL and VIKAS.
The Reserve Price of the Immovable Property will be Rs. 41,00,000/- (Rupees Forty One Lakh only) and the Earnest Money Deposit ("EMD") will be Rs. 4,10,000/- (Rupees Four Lakh Ten Thousand only) i.e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY
BUILT - UP UPPER GROUND FLOOR, PVT. NO. UGF - 002 (UGF), HAVING PLINTH AREA 70.23 SQ. MTRS., WITHOUT ROOF TERRACE RIGHTS, FRONT LHS. L - TYPE FROM 19 FT. ROAD / SOUTHERN EASTERN PORTION, PVT. NO. UGF - 002, BUILT - UP PROPERTY BEARING PLOT NO. 1 - A/2, LAND AREA MEASURING 84 SQUARE YARDS, OUT OF KHASRA NO. 301, 302 AND 309, SITUATED IN THE REVENUE ESTATE OF VILLAGE NAWADA, IN THE COLONY KNOWN AS BLOCK - G, BHAGWATI GARDEN EXTN., GALI NO 22, UTTAM NAGAR, NEW DELHI - 110059 AND THE SAME IS BOUNDED AS UNDER:
EAST : ROAD 19 FEET WIDE
WEST : PORTION OF BUILDING / OTHERS PLOT
SOUTH : PORTION OF PLOT NO. 1 - A/SHAFI 9 FEET
NORTH : FRONT RHS L - TYPE / ROAD 20 FEET WIDE
WITH COMMON ONE SMALL HATCHBACK CAR PARKING RIGHTS IN THE COMMON PARKING LOT OF THE SAID PROPERTY, ALONGWITH PROPORTIONATE UNDIVIDED, INDIVISIBLE & IMPARTIBLE OWNERSHIP RIGHTS IN THE UNDERNEATH LAND WITH ALL RIGHTS AND TITLE, WITH COMMON PASSAGES AND STAIR CASE.
For detailed terms and conditions of sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i.e. www.sammaancapital.com; Contact No : 0124-6910910, +91 7065451024; E-mail id : auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com. For bidding, log on to www.auctionfocus.in.

Authorised Officer
SAMMAAN CAPITAL LIMITED
(Formerly known as INDIABULLS HOUSING FINANCE LTD.)
Date : 11.05.2026
Place : NEW DELHI

APPENDIX IV-A
Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Property

E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.
Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to Sammaan Capital Limited (formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd.) [CIN : L65922DL2005PLC136029] ("Secured Creditor"), the constructive possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on 22.06.2026 from 05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M., for recovery of Rs. 23,01,286/- (Rupees Twenty Three Lakh One Thousand Two Hundred Eighty Six only) pending towards Loan Account No. HLAPLAJ00269913, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till 07.05.2026 with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w.e.f. 08.05.2026 along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor from DEEPAK SHARMA (DEEPAK ENGINEERING WORKS), SURENDER SHARMA and SUSHMA SHARMA.
The Reserve Price of the Immovable Property will be Rs. 22,00,000/- (Rupees Twenty Two Lakh only) and the Earnest Money Deposit ("EMD") will be Rs. 2,20,000/- (Rupees Two Lakh Twenty Thousand only) i.e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY
ALL THAT PIECES OR PARCELS OF LAND / PROPERTIES : HOUSE NO. 1822, LIG, GROUND FLOOR, HOUSING BOARD COLONY, SECTION 29, FARIDABAD, HARYANA - 122901, HAVING OVER ALL DIMENTIONS FROM OUTSIDE ARE 35.75 SQ. /YDS. BOUNDARIES OF THE PROPERTY ARE AS UNDER :-
ON EAST : H. NO. 1821 ON NORTH : ROAD
ON WEST : H. NO. 1823 ON SOUTH : H. NO. 1589

For detailed terms and conditions of sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i.e. www.sammaancapital.com; Contact No : 0124-6910910, +91 7065451024; E-mail id : auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com. For bidding, log on to www.auctionfocus.in.

Authorised Officer
SAMMAAN CAPITAL LIMITED
(Formerly known as INDIABULLS HOUSING FINANCE LTD.)
Date : 11.05.2026
Place : FARIDABAD

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tendering Notice No.: 2026-May-01 Dated: 15.05.2026

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering), North Central Railway Agra for and on behalf of the President of India invites "Open Tender" through on Line only (E-Tendering) for the following works. The details of the tender are as under:-

S.No.: 1	Tender No.: 2026-May-01-01	Approx Cost (Rs.): ₹ 5992107.20
Description of work: Dewatering of accumulated rainwater from LHS for 01 years under jurisdiction Sr. DEN-I/Agra.		

THE TEST WILL TAKE PLACE IN MULLANPUR FROM JUNE 6

Pant loses Test vice-captaincy

Selectors look for spinners beyond Jadeja and Axar

GUWAHATI: Flamboyant wicketkeeper-batter Rishabh Pant's poor form over the past six months cost him India's Test vice-captaincy and a place in the ODI squad for the home series against Afghanistan as the national selectors took a few tough calls here on Tuesday.

India will host Afghanistan for a one-off Test, which is not a part of World Test Championship cycle, along with three ODIs in June.

The Test will take place in Mullanpur from June 6, followed by three ODIs scheduled from June 14 across Dharamsala, Lucknow, and Chennai.

The Ajit Agarkar-led selection committee, following a meeting here, also decided to induct rookie left-arm orthodox spin duo of Manav Suthar and Harsh Dubey in the Test squad along with 6 feet 6 inches tall Punjab speedster Gurnoor Brar, who has only played two Ranji Trophy games this season.

As a PTI report indicated on May 17, Pant, who has been going through a prolonged lean patch in the IPL both as a batter



Wicketkeeper-batter Rishabh Pant

and captain for Lucknow Super Giants, faced the heat with the selectors replacing him with veteran KL Rahul as the Test vice-captain.

In ODIs, Ishan Kishan has

replaced him as second keeper to Rahul and pacer Prince Yadav has also made the cut.

Agarkar, who is known for taking tough calls, made it clear that the committee wants Pant

to be the best version of the Test batter that he has shown to be in the past, especially during tough overseas assignments.

"Rishabh is an incredible Test player. He is not in the

India will host Afghanistan for a one-off Test, which is not a part of World Test Championship cycle, along with three ODIs in June

ODI team at the moment. We want him to become the best Test player that he can be. I don't think there is any concern about his spot in the Test team," Agarkar replied to a query from PTI during a virtual interaction.

"He (Pant) had a really good tour of England till he got injured (toe fracture). I am sure he would like a few more runs but he has been very good in Test cricket.

Yes, we have gone with two options (Rahul and Kishan) in ODI cricket but in Test he remains one of our main players," he added implying that the flamboyant batter is not in India's white ball scheme of things.

AGENCIES

Chanmari FC salvage 2-2 draw against Rajasthan

KALYANI: Chanmari FC scored twice in stoppage time to salvage a dramatic 2-2 draw against Rajasthan United FC in their final Indian Football League Championship Phase fixture here on Tuesday.

Rajasthan appeared set to secure their first win of the Championship Phase after establishing a two-goal lead through Gerard Artigas and Thomyo L. Shimray but Chanmari produced a late comeback through Lalruatsanga in stoppage time before substitute Michael Lalbiakanga struck a dramatic equaliser in the 98th minute to earn a point.

AGENCIES

FELICITATION



U-15 Asian Gold Winner boxer Hanshika Attri honoured at Dada Dev Temple in Palam on Tuesday by the head of Palam 360 Khap Surender Solanki

NorthEast United end ISL campaign with win over Mohammedan Sporting



Players of NorthEast United FC, in red, and Mohammedan SC, in white, vie for the ball during the Indian Super League (ISL) match at the Indira Gandhi Athletic Stadium, in Guwahati on Tuesday

PTI

GUWAHATI: NorthEast United FC finished their Indian Super League campaign on a high after clinching a 2-0 win against relegated Mohammedan Sporting Club here on Tuesday.

Jairo Samperio and Dinesh Singh Soraisham found the net for the Highlanders, who climbed one place to ninth in the table and concluded their campaign with 16 points. Mohammedan SC, who had

their relegation confirmed earlier in the season, finished at the bottom of the standings with three points, ending their campaign without a win.

Mohammedan created the first notable opening in the 13th minute.

Thokchom Adison Singh made a darting run down the right flank before cutting inside the box and shooting low at the near post. However, the effort took a deflection, allow-

ing NorthEast goalkeeper Dipesh Chauhan to gather comfortably.

NorthEast took the lead in the 19th minute following sustained pressure around the Mohammedan Sporting penalty area. Jithin delivered an inswinging corner towards the near post, and Jairo got there first, directing a header across goal and into the far corner, leaving Nikhil Deka with no chance.

AGENCIES

Super Sooryavanshi takes RR closer to play-offs

JAIPUR: Vaibhav Sooryavanshi continued his evening ritual of leaving spectators spellbound with a breathtaking 38-ball 93 as Rajasthan Royals moved closer to a playoff berth with a one-sided seven-wicket win over Lucknow Super Giants in an IPL match here on Tuesday.

The 15-year-old, who is all set to board the flight to Dublin with the Indian senior team next month, was once again unstoppable, clobbering 10 sixes in an extraordinary display of bat speed and razor-sharp hand-eye coordination.

By the time, he missed



Rajasthan Royals' Vaibhav Sooryavanshi in action

PTI

out on his third IPL century by a mere seven runs, he had ensured Royals will make a

meal of what could have been a tricky 221 run chase after Mitchell Marsh's 57-ball-96

had taken LSG to 220 for 5.

And certainly, the icing on the cake was Ian Bishop's line on air, one that could well be remembered for posterity: "He is ready."

Royals are now on 14 points and would need a win against Mumbai Indians in their last game to make it to play-off.

If Marsh was muscularity pro-max, Sooryavanshi was all about amazing skill-set where a leg-spinner's slider delivered at an angle could be dispatched into extra cover stands with disdain. While Marsh hit poor balls for sixes, Sooryavanshi sent the good ones sailing into

the stands. And when it came to poor deliveries, he tortured them.

He is well on his way (53) to break Chris Gayle's (59) record of maximum sixes in a season. He is now 26 runs short of completing 600 runs in the season.

Dhruv Jurel completed the chase with an unbeaten 38-ball 53 but the night unquestionably belonged to the teenage sensation.

Mayank Yadav, the man who burst into the 2024 IPL as India's fastest ever bowler, was dispatched for 29 runs in a single over.

AGENCIES

Leisure



She pointed out that the regional industries in the South have yet to master the art of writing for older women as excellently as Hindi cinema does now

'HAVE DONE CERTAIN FILMS IN SOUTH WHEN I WAS YOUNG'

Jyotika shared she was embraced by the South film industry while Bollywood rejected her

Although Jyotika made her acting debut in Bollywood with director Priyadarshan's 'Doli Saja Ke Rakhna' (1998), a remake of the Malayalam film 'Aniyathipraavu' (1997), it was the Tamil film industry that catapulted her to stardom, offering her a wide range of characters. A five-time recipient of the Tamil Nadu State Film Award for 'Best Actress', the most by any artiste, Jyotika ranks among the most successful actors in the industry. In fact, her stardom reached such high levels in the 2000s that she often gave her male contemporaries a run for their money.

While she has worked in several Hindi films over the years, Jyotika recently admitted that she wouldn't have attained as much success had she confined herself to Bollywood. Although her debut films in both Hindi and Tamil flopped, Jyotika noted that, while she immediately stopped receiving work in Bollywood, numerous opportunities began coming her way in Tamil, as the industry was more focused on her performance and unperturbed by the box-office verdicts of her movies.

"I have done certain films in South when I was young, which I really don't know if I would have had those choices if I were here in Bollywood. My first Hindi film didn't do well at the



box office, and the doors were immediately shut for me. At the same time, my first Tamil film also didn't do well at the box office, but they looked at my work and I got flooded by film offers after that," she said during a conversation with 'Times Entertainment'.

Sharing that the South Indian film industry has offered her a wide range of roles since her start, Jyotika noted, "I feel, I may not have received those kinds of opportunities here." She nonetheless pointed out that the regional industries in the South have yet to master the art of writing for older women as excellently as Hindi cinema does now.

"When I returned to Bollywood in my 40s, I felt that the way they are writing for women here, we still have to explore that space in the South. Female characters aged 40 and above are sensibly written here. So, both Bollywood and the South industry have their pluses and minuses," she added.

Jyotika is currently gearing up for the release of her 'Amazon Prime Video' film, 'System', directed by Ashwiny Iyer Tiwari. The legal drama also features Sonakshi Sinha and Ashutosh Gowariker in key roles. She was last seen in the 'Netflix' crime drama series 'Dabba Cartel' (2025).

'LEARNED A LOT ABOUT HIS MINDSET AS A WRITER'

Sunny talks about Surendra Mohan Pathak

Sunny Hinduja currently stars in the web series 'Vimal Khanna'

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Amazon MX Player continues to captivate audiences with 'Vimal Khanna', the gripping survival thriller inspired by the iconic literary universe created by celebrated author Surendra Mohan Pathak.

Bringing the emotionally layered Vimal to life, Sunny Hinduja recently opened up about the personal moments that helped him connect deeply with the character, while also expressing immense admiration for Pathak's enduring legacy and visionary storytelling.

Reflecting on his emotional connection with Vimal Khanna, Sunny shared, "I don't think there was one particular moment where I became Vimal, but during the course of filming,

his situations and his connection with family really resonated with me. Especially the scenes involving the loss of his brother and mother, those moments felt very heavy and personal. What also connected me deeply with Vimal was his resilience. Despite everything he goes through, he still stands tall with integrity and stays true to himself. Shooting with my close friend Krishna Singh Bisht also made some moments feel very natural and personal."

He further added his admiration for Surendra Mohan Pathak's timeless storytelling: "Unfortunately, I couldn't meet Surendra Mohan Pathak in person due to time constraints. The love people across the country have for him is honestly mind-blowing."

Hinduja shared about the personal moments that helped him connect deeply with the character

